

Section X: Cybersecurity & Cyber-Resilience Strategy for Sovereign Cloud/Edge Computing - Cybersecurity for the Cognitive Computing Continuum

Contents

1	Introduction	3
2	Background & Driving Factors	6
2.1	Europe in Relation to the State of the Art	6
3	Methodology	7
3.1	Strategic Preamble	7
3.2	The 4-Filter Prioritization Framework	7
3.3	The Anatomy of a Roadmap Priorities: A 7-Dimensional Analysis - Note: Translating Priorities into Actionable R&I Guidance	8
4	Progression Matrix: Sequence of Events (X-Axis)	11
5	The Core Capability Dimensions (Architectural Framework)	11
6	Priorities	17
6.1	Executive Priorities: The Critical Path (Phase 1)	17
7	Capability Profiles & Progression Matrices	18
8	Executive Summary & Strategic Recommendations	31
A	Master Prompt for Generating Capability Profiles	33
B	Execution Roadmap for Implementation	37
C	Capability Profiles & Progression Matrices	41
D	Master Population Prompt for Roadmap Generation	43
E	The Core Capability Dimensions (Architectural Framework)	44
F	Capability Profiles & Progression Matrices	46

G	Executive Summary & Strategic Recommendations	53
H	Summary outcome	54
I	Section X: Cybersecurity & Cyber-Resilience Strategy for Sovereign Cloud/Edge Computing	54
I.1	1. Background & Driving Factors	55
I.2	2. Europe in Relation to the State of the Art	55
I.3	3. Strategic Preamble	55
I.4	4. The Core Capability Dimensions (Architectural Framework)	55
	I.4.1 Part A: The Security Layers (Vertical Stack)	55
	I.4.2 Part B: The Transversal Verticals (Cross-Layers)	56
I.5	5. The 4-Filter Prioritization Framework	56
I.6	6. Detailed Priority Profiles & Progression Matrices	57
	I.6.1 Priority 1: Hardware Roots of Trust & EUCC 'High'	57
	I.6.2 Priority 2: PQC Agility for Edge/IoT	57
	I.6.3 Priority 3: Security Interoperability via Simpl Middleware	58
I.7	References	58

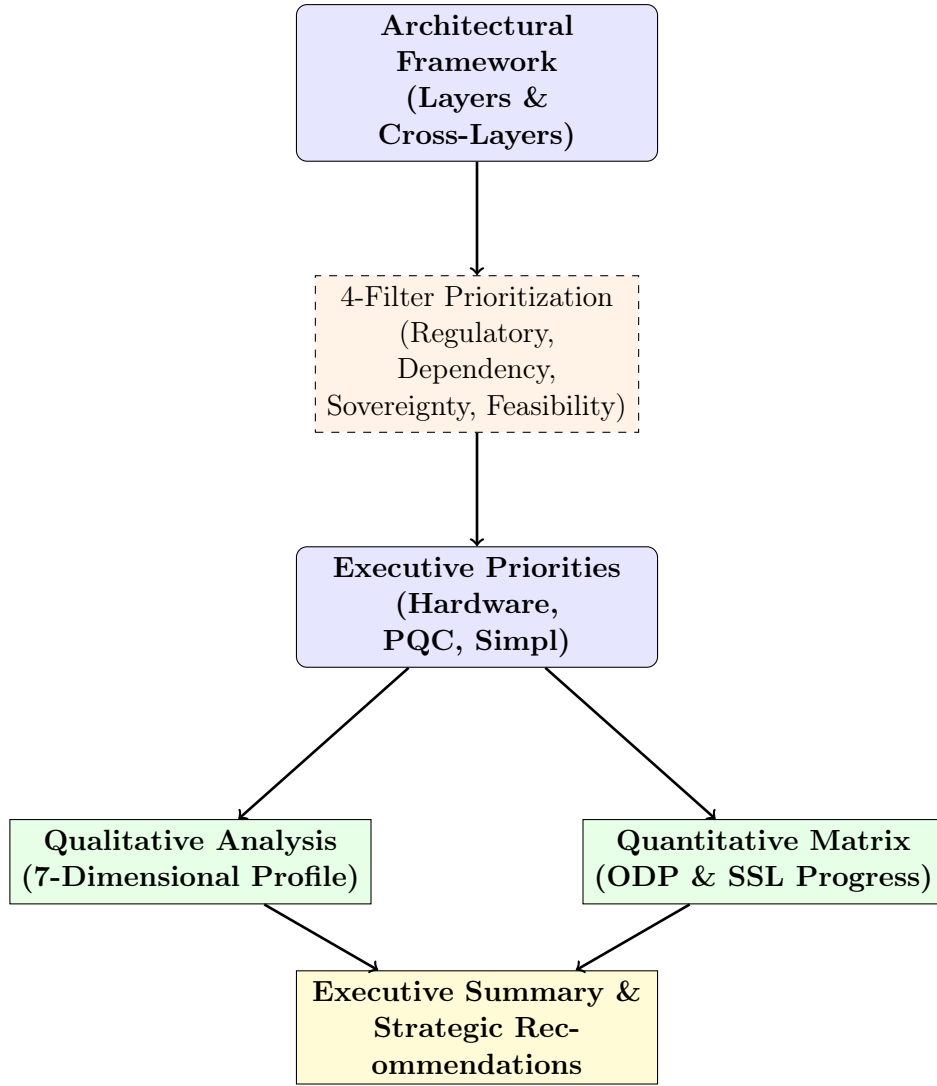


Figure 1: Logical structure of the Roadmap: From Architectural Framework to Strategic Outcomes.

1 Introduction

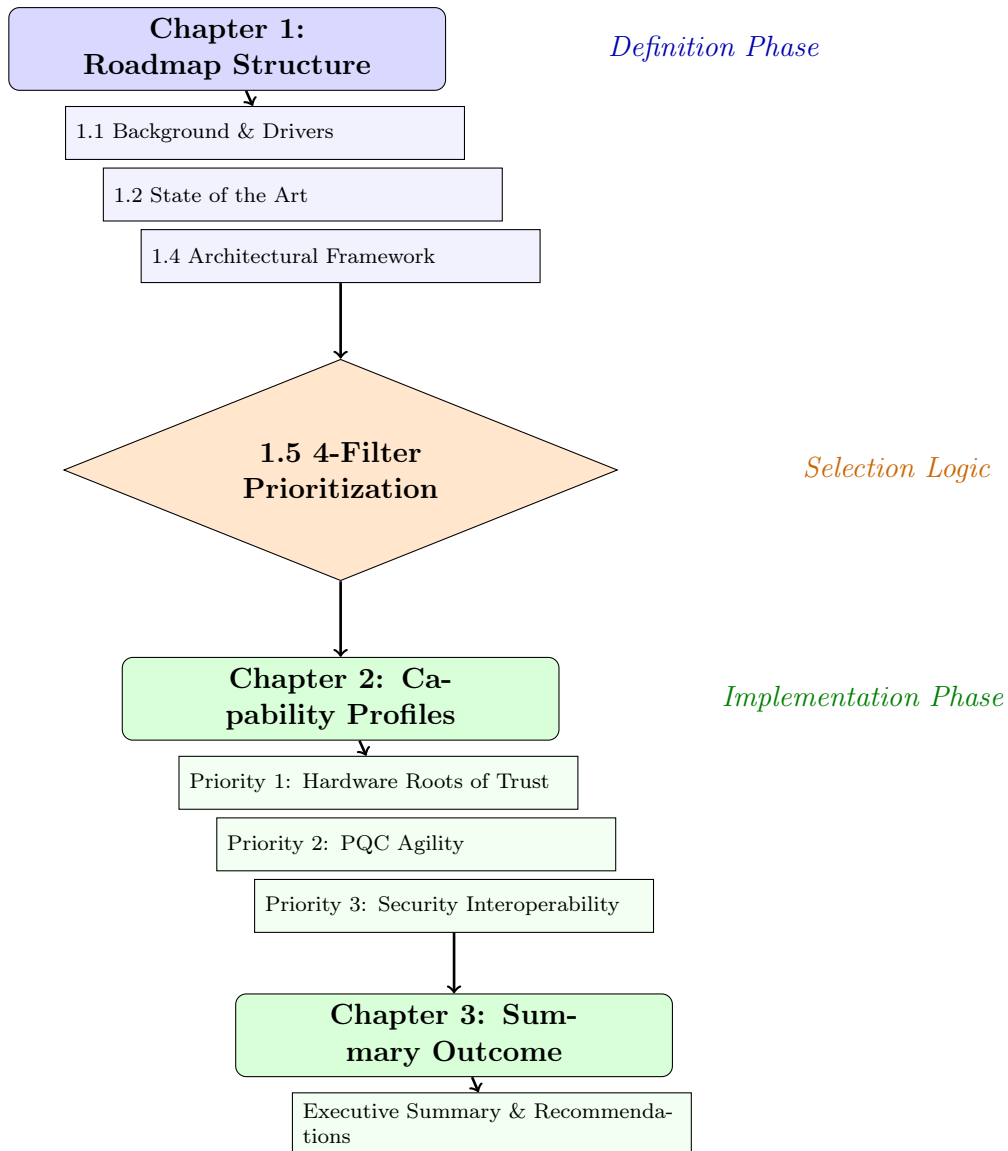


Figure 2: Logical structure of the Roadmap: Mapping Chapter hierarchy to the strategic selection process.

Note: Instructions for Using This Roadmap Framework

Purpose of This Document

This roadmap provides a structured methodology for European policymakers, research organizations, and industry stakeholders to:

- Identify and prioritize cybersecurity R&I investments for the Cloud-Edge-IoT continuum
- Track capability maturity using objective Operational Deployment Phase (ODP) and Strategic Sovereignty Level (SSL) metrics
- Align Horizon Europe funding with strategic autonomy goals and regulatory compliance requirements

- Ensure coordinated implementation across Member States and European initiatives (ECCC, Digital Europe Programme, EU Chips Act)

Target Audiences

European Commission & Funding Bodies: Use the 4-Filter Prioritization Framework to allocate Horizon Europe, Digital Europe Programme, and ECCC funding to capabilities with the highest strategic impact.

National Cybersecurity Agencies: Leverage the progression matrices to coordinate national R&I investments with EU-wide timelines and ensure interoperability across Member States.

Research Consortia & Industry: Utilize the 7-Dimensional Analysis template to structure project proposals, clearly articulating baseline, target, drivers, risks, and alignment with European strategic goals.

Standardization Bodies (CEN/CENELEC, ETSI): Reference the architectural framework and MIMs to develop harmonized standards for secure, interoperable computing continuum infrastructure.

How to Navigate This Document

1. **Start with Section 1-3:** Understand the threat landscape, regulatory drivers, and strategic context for securing the European computing continuum.
2. **Review Section 4:** Familiarize yourself with the 6 Security Layers and 4 Cross-Layers comprising the architectural framework.
3. **Apply Section 5:** Use the 4-Filter Prioritization Framework to assess which capabilities are critical for your specific context (national strategy, industrial sector, research focus).
4. **Study Section 6-7:** Understand the 7-Dimensional Analysis methodology and ODP/SSL progression metrics before designing projects or policies.
5. **Reference Section 9 (Priorities 1-3):** Use the detailed capability profiles as templates for structuring additional priorities relevant to your domain.
6. **Implement Section 10:** Actionable strategic recommendations for Phase 1 (2025-2030) provide concrete next steps.

Key Principles

- **Evidence-Based Prioritization:** All priorities must pass the 4-Filter Framework (Regulatory Urgency, Foundational Dependency, Sovereignty Cliff, Market Feasibility).
- **Sovereignty-First Design:** Investments should systematically reduce foreign dependencies (measured via SSL metrics) while building European industrial capacity.

- **Compliance-by-Design:** All R&I outputs must align with or anticipate NIS2, CRA, AI Act, and Data Act requirements to ensure market relevance.
- **Federated Interoperability:** Solutions must prioritize standardization and open architectures (e.g., Simpl middleware, open-source RISC-V) over proprietary, siloed approaches.
- **Measurable Progression:** Avoid subjective TRL assessments; instead, use objective ODP (market integration) and SSL (sovereignty) metrics with clear phase transition criteria.

2 Background & Driving Factors

Destinations:

- **Primary:** 4. A secure, sovereign European computing continuum infrastructure.
- **Secondary:** 6. European leadership in emerging disruptive computing paradigms.
- **Decentralization Risk:** The paradigm shift from the centralized Cloud to a distributed Cloud-Edge-IoT continuum radically expands the attack surface. This creates environments that are often “too many, too diverse, and too dispersed” to secure with traditional perimeter defenses.
- **Physical Exposure:** Edge nodes and far-edge IoT devices frequently operate in the field. Unlike hyperscaler data centers, they lack strict physical and environmental security controls, making them highly vulnerable to tampering.
- **Regulatory Pressure:** There is an immediate, complex need to operationalize the NIS2 Directive [1], the Cyber Resilience Act (CRA) [2], and the AI Act [3] across a highly fragmented technological ecosystem to ensure compliance and market access.
- **Digital Sovereignty:** Europe must urgently reduce its systemic reliance on non-EU technology providers. Doing so will mitigate extra-territorial data access risks and avoid geopolitical vendor lock-in, ensuring independent control over critical infrastructure.

2.1 Europe in Relation to the State of the Art

Comparison vs. Hyperscalers:

- **EU Strengths:** Europe leads globally in Trust, Privacy-by-Design, proactive regulation (GDPR, Data Act, AI Act), and rigorous, standardized certification frameworks (e.g., EUCS [4]).
- **EU Gaps:** The European market suffers from a lack of unified, hyper-scale security orchestration. Furthermore, there is a critical dependency on non-EU hardware (secure silicon) and highly fragmented threat intelligence sharing among member states.

Strategic Goal: To definitively transition the European computing continuum from a state of “reactive, siloed security” to an advanced architecture defined by “autonomous, federated, and certified Security-by-Design.”

3 Methodology

3.1 Strategic Preamble

- **Context:** This section defines the architectural guardrails required to secure the Cloud-Edge-IoT Continuum. It moves beyond traditional “perimeter security” toward a model of Cyber-Resilience—where systems are engineered to proactively anticipate, withstand, recover from, and adapt to attacks while maintaining strict Digital Sovereignty.
- **Approach:** To provide actionable, risk-aware Research & Innovation (R&I) priorities, the strategy is organized into a two-part framework:
 - **Capability Profiles (Qualitative):** A deep-dive 7-dimensional analysis defining exactly what needs to be built.
 - **Progression Matrix (Quantitative & Strategic):** A structured timeline tracking the evolution of capabilities through their Operational Deployment Phases and their trajectory toward Strategic Sovereignty.

3.2 The 4-Filter Prioritization Framework

To ensure the roadmap provides actionable guidance for European R&I funding (Horizon Europe) and strategic investment, capabilities are prioritized using a structured 4-filter logic. This objective is to identify the “Critical Path” items that require immediate resource allocation during Phase 1 (0–5 years) in order to enable a secure and sovereign European Cloud-Edge-IoT computing continuum.

1. Regulatory Urgency – Compliance Filter (The “Must-Do” Filter):

- **Question:** Is this capability required to meet imminent European regulatory obligations (e.g., NIS2 [1], Cyber Resilience Act [2], AI Act [3])?
- **Logic:** If failure to achieve this by 2026 results in market exclusion or systemic non-compliance, it is designated as **Priority #1**.

2. Foundational Dependency – Architecture Filter (The “Blocker” Filter):

- **Question:** Do subsequent security layers depend on this capability existing first?
- **Logic:** Foundational technologies (e.g., Layer 1 Hardware Trust) outrank high-level software orchestration. You cannot secure the user (Layer 4) if the hardware (Layer 1) cannot provide a verifiable anchor.

3. The Sovereignty Cliff / Strategic Sovereignty Risk – Resilience Filter (The “Extinction” Filter):

- **Question:** Does a lack of this tech pose an existential threat to EU sovereignty or systemic resilience?
- **Logic:** This prioritizes areas where the EU currently has 100% foreign dependency or where a technical breakthrough (e.g., *Q-Day* Quantum threat) would render existing defenses obsolete.

4. Market Feasibility & Ecosystem Alignment – Adoption Filter (The “Simpl/SME” Filter):

- **Question:** Does this align with existing EU heavy-investments (e.g., Simpl [6]) and is it adoptable by SMEs?
- **Logic:** Priority is given to capabilities that act as force-multipliers for existing infrastructure, ensuring economic viability.

Capabilities that satisfy multiple filters are classified as *Executive Priorities* and define the critical investment path for the secure European computing continuum.

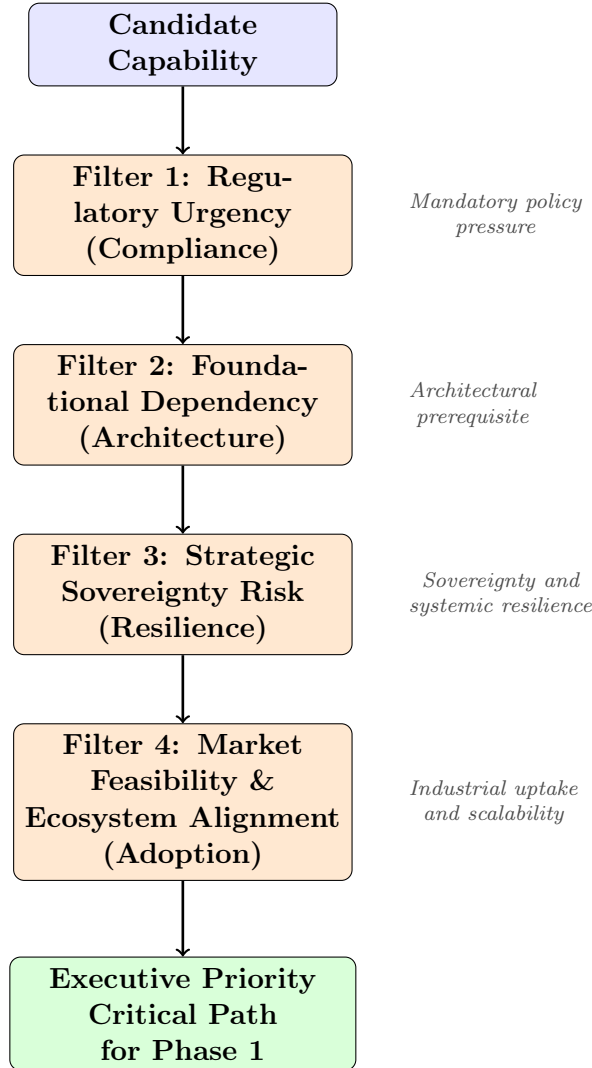


Figure 3: Four-filter prioritization pipeline used to identify Executive Priorities for the European Cloud–Edge–IoT cybersecurity roadmap.

3.3 The Anatomy of a Roadmap Priorities: A 7-Dimensional Analysis - Note: Translating Priorities into Actionable R&I Guidance

To ensure the roadmap is actionable, realistic, and aligned with European strategic autonomy, every priority is analyzed holistically through a strict 7-point structural template:

1. **Baseline & Target Objective (The Trajectory) - Q: Where do we stand today, and what exactly does success look like?**

Description: Establishes the starting point of the priority today and defines the ultimate maturity state required by the end of the 15-year roadmap.

- **Baseline (Where we are):** Grounds the roadmap in reality. It captures the state of the art, current Operational Deployment Phase (ODP), Strategic Sovereignty Level (SSL), industrial capacity, reliance on foreign vendors, and the technical or economic barriers preventing immediate adoption.
- **Target (Where we need to be):** Sets the baseline for EU-funded projects, defining the target ODP and SSL that must be achieved by the end of the roadmap.

2. **Primary Drivers (The “Push” Factors) - Q: Why must we prioritize building this capability right now? SQ: Why are we doing this?**

Description: Outlines the external pressures—both from the evolving threat landscape and mandatory EU regulations—that make this technological evolution urgent and unavoidable.

- **Threat Drivers:** The rapid advancement of adversarial capabilities (e.g., offensive AI, quantum decryption, supply chain targeting).
- **Regulatory Drivers:** Imminent EU compliance mandates that require technical operationalization (e.g., NIS2, Cyber Resilience Act, AI Act).

3. **High Impact Activities - Q: Which specific actions provide the greatest leap in European sovereignty and security? SQ: Which should be the key initiatives?**

Description: Highlights the specific, prioritized technical interventions within this broader capability group that will yield the highest strategic return on investment.

4. **Catalysts & Enablers (The “Pull” Factors & EU Support) - Q: What specific EU funding, standards, and ecosystem support do we need? SQ: How do we get there & accelerate?**

Description: Identifies the concrete mechanisms, funding vehicles, and regulatory standardizations required from the EU to accelerate market adoption and push the industry from the baseline to the target state.

- **R&I & Funding Alignment:** Required Horizon Europe funding topics and targeted innovation instruments. Investment priorities must be explicitly synchronized with the European Cybersecurity Competence Centre (ECCC) Strategic Agenda [8] to ensure alignment with pan-European goals (e.g., PQC transition infrastructure, AI-driven security tools).
- **Regulatory & Standardization:** Alignment with standard-setting bodies (CEN/CENELEC) and certification frameworks (e.g., EUCS, EUCC).
- **Ecosystem:** Support for ecosystem building, industrial partnerships, and capacity-building initiatives (e.g., federated Cyber Ranges) to upskill the workforce and ensure advanced security solutions are economically viable for SMEs.

5. **Disruptors & Systemic Risks (The Roadblocks) - Q: What structural vulnerabilities, market failures, or adversary breakthroughs could derail us? SQ: What can break the path?**

Description: Acknowledges that innovation is not linear by identifying severe technical and architectural risks that could actively derail deployment. It places primary emphasis on “Technical Cliffs” —moments where defensive capabilities are rendered obsolete by adversarial breakthroughs before countermeasures are fully deployed.

- **Cryptographic Obsolescence & Migration Bottlenecks (The Primary Technical Risk):**

- *The “Q-Day” Cliff:* The risk that Cryptographically Relevant Quantum Computers (CRQC) become operational before the EU completes its migration to Post-Quantum Cryptography (PQC). This creates a “Harvest Now, Decrypt Later” vulnerability.
- *Migration Complexity:* The systemic failure to inventory and replace deep-rooted Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) in legacy OT/IoT environments.

- **Adversarial Breakthroughs:** The risk of threat actors weaponizing emerging technologies (e.g., AI-driven exploit generation, polymorphic malware) faster than defensive R&I can mitigate them.

- **Contextual Risks (Non-Technical / Optional):** Geopolitics & Supply Chain dependencies, Market & Tech Risks (monopolization, fragmented standards).

6. **Failsafe Mechanisms & Resilience (The Safety Nets) - Q: If this technology is compromised, how does the system survive and gracefully degrade? SQ: How do we prevent failure?**

Description: The technical core of “Cyber-Resilience.” It defines the engineering fallbacks required if a primary capability fails, is breached, or is disrupted by the systemic risks identified above.

What it entails: Designing for degraded modes of operation, architectural redundancies, autonomous isolation protocols, and implementation diversity to avoid vulnerable technological monocultures.

7. **Transversal Meta-Layer (The Policy Alignment) - Q: How does mastering this capability support Europe’s goals of sovereignty, sustainability, and trust? SQ: The broader policy context?**

Description: Elevates the technical capability back to the overarching political and societal goals of the European Union.

- **Sovereignty & Autonomy:** Strengthening European strategic independence, reducing reliance on non-EU vendors.
- **Trust & Ethics:** Fostering deep Societal Trust by guaranteeing data privacy (Privacy-by-Design), algorithmic fairness, and transparency.
- **Sustainable Security (Green IT):** Minimizing the environmental impact of cyber defense (e.g., energy-efficient cryptographic algorithms, crypto-agility to reduce e-waste).

4 Progression Matrix: Sequence of Events (X-Axis)

Instead of a strictly chronological timeline, the roadmap maps the sequence of critical events required to unlock maturity. This ensures that foundational capabilities are built before advanced autonomous systems.

- **Phase 1: Foundation & Compliance (Immediate Implementation):** Focuses on state-of-practice deployments, bridging immediate capability gaps, and addressing urgent regulatory obligations (NIS2, CRA).
- **Phase 2: Federation & Standardization (Scaling & Harmonization):** Focuses on deploying emerging technologies, establishing harmonized governance frameworks, and managing critical transition periods.
- **Phase 3: Autonomy & Leadership (Sovereign Innovation):** Focuses on highly speculative but structured foresight, including defense against quantum-capable adversaries and the achievement of fully sovereign, autonomous cloud-edge ecosystems.

Matrix Cell Content Definition (Measuring Progression)

Rather than relying on subjective Technology Readiness Levels (TRL) or Manufacturing Readiness Levels (MRL) for a highly fragmented ecosystem, each cell in the progression matrix tracks maturity using objective strategic market and policy indicators:

- **Operational Deployment Phase (ODP):** Tracks the market reality and integration status (e.g., *Applied R&D* → *Fragmented Piloting* → *Standardized Integration* → *Ubiquitous Operation*).
- **Strategic Sovereignty Level (SSL):** Tracks European strategic autonomy and reliance on foreign vendors (e.g., *High Foreign Dependency* → *Emerging EU Ecosystem* → *Full Sovereign Autonomy*).
- **Operational State:** A concise snapshot characterizing the reality on the ground during this phase.
- **Critical Enabler:** The single most critical regulation, standard, or European R&I breakthrough unlocking the transition to the next phase.

5 The Core Capability Dimensions (Architectural Framework)

As it is illustrated in Figure 4, the roadmap is structured across a cohesive architectural framework that spans four continuum environments (HPC, Cloud, Edge, Devices). The capabilities are organized into Six Security Layers (The Vertical Stack) and Four Transversal Cross-Layers (The Horizontal Enablers).

Part A: The Security Layers (Vertical Stack)

These layers define the specific technical security controls implemented across the computing infrastructure.

Security Framework with Separated Security Verticals

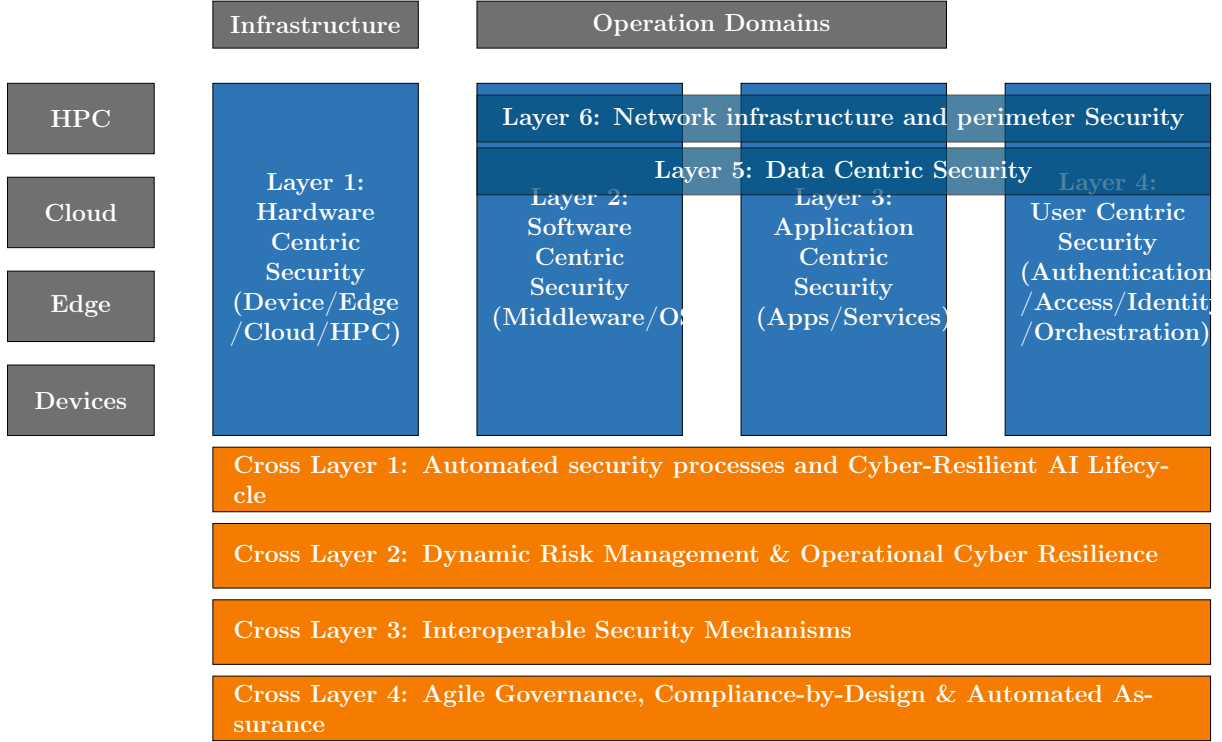


Figure 4: Security Framework with separated security verticals in dedicated boxes.

Layer 1: Hardware-Centric Security

1.1 Hardware Roots of Trust: Cryptographically verifiable supply chain trust (e.g., TPM attestation, secure enclaves) ensures physical device integrity. Success depends on driving European open-hardware designs (e.g., RISC-V) toward **EUCC 'High' assurance level certification** [5] to mathematically guarantee resistance against state-level physical tampering and side-channel attacks at the vulnerable far-edge. **1.2 Physical-Layer (PHY) Threat Detection & Fingerprinting:** Exploiting intrinsic wireless channel characteristics, such as Channel State Information (CSI), Carrier Frequency Offset (CFO), and Received Signal Strength Indicator (RSSI). That is to establish real-time, keyless device authentication and anomaly detection at the lowest layer of the stack. This provides a hardware-anchored security primitive that is resilient even when upper-layer cryptographic processing is compromised or infeasible.

Layer 2: Software-Centric Security (Middleware/OS)

2.1 OS & Middleware Hardening: Securing hypervisors, container runtimes, and distributed operating systems is critical for isolation. This involves hardening KVM/QEMU and supporting sovereign, lightweight Linux distributions optimized for edge resource constraints, ensuring a reduced attack surface for the cognitive continuum.

2.2 Secure OTA Patch & Update Management: Edge nodes deployed in the field—smart grids, O-RAN radios, industrial gateways—require cryptographically verified, failure-resilient over-the-air (OTA) update pipelines. A compromised or failed up-

date mechanism can render entire fleets of field-deployed nodes permanently vulnerable, making robust OTA management a critical software-layer capability.

Layer 3: Application-Centric Security (Apps/Services)

3.1 Workload Security: Securing containerized applications, microservices, and serverless functions executing dynamically across multi-provider nodes. This is achieved through hardened service meshes and sidecar proxy architectures that provide mutual TLS and granular traffic inspection without impacting performance.

3.2 In-Band Network Telemetry (INT) & Deep Observability: Embedding “smart telemetry” directly into the data packets traversing containerized workloads and service meshes, providing granular, real-time visibility into network behaviour and performance without requiring out-of-band monitoring infrastructure. This feeds high-fidelity signals to security analytics platforms.

3.3 API Security Gateway & Policy Enforcement: As containerized AI workloads increasingly communicate through REST/gRPC APIs, a dedicated API security gateway provides a unified enforcement point for authentication tokens, rate limiting, schema validation, and payload inspection—preventing injection attacks and data exfiltration at the application boundary.

Layer 4: User & Orchestration-Centric Security

4.1 Zero-Trust Orchestration: Seamless policy enforcement across a multi-provider computing continuum requires robust Policy Enforcement Point (PEP) and Policy Decision Point (PDP) architectures. This enables continuous authorization and dynamic access controls that adapt to the context of the request.

4.2 Federated Identity & Access Management (IAM): Cross-domain identity federation and verifiable credentials for machines, users, and automated workloads. Implementing **Self-Sovereign Identity (SSI)** principles allows for cryptographically secure, decentralized authentication across heterogeneous cloud-edge domains.

4.3 Privileged Access Management (PAM) & Just-In-Time (JIT) Access: Lateral movement by attackers frequently exploits over-provisioned standing privileges—the precise vector behind major Advanced Persistent Threat (APT) campaigns. PAM and JIT access controls ensure that elevated privileges are granted only for defined, time-bounded sessions with full auditability, minimizing the blast radius of any credential compromise.

Layer 5: Data-Centric Security

5.1 End-to-end Confidential Computing: Data-in-use security through Trusted Execution Environments (TEEs) spanning the entire Cloud-to-IoT data path. Leveraging TEE abstraction layers and remote attestation ensures that sensitive European data remains encrypted even during processing in non-trusted environments.

5.2 Post-Quantum & Cryptographic Agility: PQC standardization and hybrid crypto deployment are necessary to secure long-lived data. Priority is placed on **PQC migration for resource-constrained devices**, ensuring that edge infrastructure is resilient against “Harvest Now, Decrypt Later” quantum threats.

5.3 Signaling (Data) Security: Moving beyond best-effort packet forwarding by embedding trust directly into the network signaling architecture. This ensures the in-

tegrity and authenticity of control-plane messages, preventing hijacking of routing decisions and network configuration across the distributed continuum.

5.4 Distributed Reputation & Trust Networking: Implementing a ubiquitous, real-time reputation system built on Distributed Ledger Technology (DLT) and smart contracts. This enables autonomous, evidence-based trust decisions about nodes, services, and data sources across the continuum without reliance on a central authority.

5.5 Quantum Key Distribution (QKD) for Critical Links: While PQC addresses algorithmic quantum-resistance, QKD provides information-theoretically secure key exchange over optical fibre for point-to-point high-value links (government, critical infrastructure backbone). These two technologies are complementary and together form a comprehensive quantum-safe strategy.

5.6 Secure Multi-Party Computation (SMPC): Homomorphic Encryption and TEEs (Layer 5.1) handle confidential computing for single-party workloads. SMPC enables multiple mutually distrusting parties to jointly compute a function over their combined private inputs without revealing those inputs to each other—a critical capability for cross-border analytics and federated AI in regulated sectors.

Layer 6: Network Infrastructure & Perimeter-Centric Security

6.1 Telco-cloud & O-RAN Security: Hardening distributed 5G/6G cores and RAN components must align with the **Smart Networks and Services Joint Undertaking (SNS JU) SRIA** [7]. This ensures sovereign control over network slice isolation and virtualized RAN components.

6.2 Cross-Sector Physical Resilience & Safety: Adapting strict network controls and IT/OT gateway security for high-availability edge environments (e.g., Smart Grids). This guarantees that cyber-breaches in the digital layer do not cascade into physical safety hazards or kinetic damage in critical infrastructure.

6.3 Edge-Native Autonomous Guardians: Hosting lightweight, localized security control functions (Security-as-a-Service aggregators) directly at the far-edge gateways or within Open-RAN Radio Intelligent Controllers (RIC). These autonomous guardian nodes execute real-time threat mitigation without requiring round-trip communication to a centralized cloud-based SOC, dramatically reducing response latency.

6.4 Non-Terrestrial Network (NTN) & Satellite Security: 6G will natively integrate satellite segments for coverage continuity, backhaul resilience, and emergency operations. These non-terrestrial links introduce distinct threat surfaces—including signal interception and orbital spoofing—requiring dedicated security requirements aligned with 3GPP NTN specifications and the EU Space Programme.

Part B: The Transversal Security Verticals (Cross-Layers)

These four cross-layers represent continuous, automated processes and governance structures that intersect every layer of the vertical stack.

Cross-Layer 1: Automated Security Processes & Cyber-Resilient AI Lifecycle

CL1.1 Continuous DevSecOps (Shift-Left): Embedding AI-driven code analysis and automated vulnerability remediation at the earliest stages of the software lifecycle.

CL1.2 Model & Pipeline Integrity (DataBOMs): Securing AI training pipelines to prevent data poisoning and unauthorized model manipulation.

CL1.3 Runtime AI Defense: Defending AI/ML infrastructure against real-world adversarial attacks (e.g., prompt injection, model evasion/theft) at the edge.

CL1.4 Dynamic Supply Chain Verification (Runtime SBOMs): Moving beyond static software manifests by implementing dynamic Software Bill of Materials (Runtime SBOMs) and “cryptographic proof of execution” to continuously verify the integrity of containerized microservices and AI components as they migrate across the multi-provider edge-cloud continuum.

CL1.5 Automated Adversarial Testing & Continuous Purple Teaming: DevSecOps pipelines focus on code analysis and remediation; the adversarial counterpart provides continuous automated penetration testing, fuzzing (coverage-guided and protocol-level), and purple-team automation that simulates real attacker behaviour against live staging environments, ensuring defenses are validated continuously rather than at periodic intervals.

Cross-Layer 2: Dynamic Risk Management & Operational Cyber Resilience

CL2.1 Automated SOC Operations & Collaborative Threat Intelligence: Continuous monitoring, SOC federation across Member States, and automated incident containment, underpinned by legally protected, cross-border threat intelligence sharing ecosystems designed to overcome institutional trust barriers and incentivize active collaboration [9].

CL2.2 Systemic & Cascading Risk Mitigation: Mapping the evolving threat landscape and using impact-likelihood scoring to dynamically sever links and prevent cross-domain systemic failures.

CL2.3 High-Precision Telemetry and Security Signalling: Implementing “smart telemetry” and cybersecurity-related signalling to feed real-time threat intelligence into analytics platforms without overwhelming network bandwidth—ensuring that visibility does not itself become an attack vector or performance bottleneck.

CL2.4 Internet of Behavior (IoB) and Evidence Sharing: Utilizing cybersecurity and QoS signalling traffic to extract and share behavioral patterns across the infrastructure, establishing an “Internet of Behavior” that enables proactive anomaly correlation and evidence-based risk assessment at continental scale.

CL2.5 AI-Native Analytics Integration (NWDAF & LLMSecOps): Routing cybersecurity signalling traffic and telemetry through centralized analytics hubs powered by AI agents. This creates a live “nervous system” for the network, allowing AI agents to continuously monitor for zero-day exploits, analyze encrypted traffic flows, and trigger automated incident responses aligned with NWDAF (Network Data Analytics Function) standards.

CL2.6 Cyber Threat Intelligence (CTI) Lifecycle Management: While CL2.1 and CL2.4 consume and act on threat data, explicit governance of the full CTI lifecycle—collection, processing, analysis, dissemination, and feedback—is required as a prerequisite for the federated SOC vision. A sovereign EU CTI platform must define this governance layer to ensure data quality, legal compliance, and attribution reliability.

CL2.7 Cyber Deception Technology & Active Defense (Honeynets, Canaries): Current detection is passive—telemetry is observed and anomalies flagged. Deception adds an active intelligence-collection dimension by deploying decoy assets (honeypots, honeynets, credential canaries, fake API endpoints) that generate high-fidelity, low-noise alerts when touched, enabling early detection of advanced intrusions and insider

threats.

Cross-Layer 3: Interoperable Security Mechanisms & Open-Source Verifiability

CL3.1 Heterogeneous Interoperability & Simpl Integration: Secure communication and data exchange across disparate systems, edge nodes, and proprietary domains. This includes mandatory alignment with and integration into the Simpl open-source smart middleware [6] to ensure secure, federated access across Common European Data Spaces.

CL3.2 Minimal Interoperability Mechanisms (MIMs) & Open Verifiability: Establishing standardized, baseline security and privacy controls to ensure trust without creating vendor lock-in. This relies heavily on embracing open-source software and open hardware architectures as fundamental prerequisites for transparency, cryptographic verifiability, and the elimination of proprietary black-box vulnerabilities [6].

CL3.3 Neutral Host and Multi-Tenant Isolation: As the ecosystem shifts toward infrastructure sharing and Neutral Host models spanning wireless, optical, and cloud domains, robust isolation between tenants is critical. Security architectures must enforce Zero-Trust edge operations across different network partitions to prevent cross-tenant data leakage and privilege escalation.

CL3.4 Pan-European NaaS Federation and Cross-Border Edge Roaming: Establishing standardized interfaces and harmonized Network APIs (e.g., leveraging CAMARA) to interconnect the fragmented edge clouds of different European telecom operators into a unified Network-as-a-Service (NaaS) platform—enabling a “Schengen for Cloud/AI” where compute workloads can roam seamlessly across borders.

CL3.5 Semantic Security Interoperability (Common Ontologies & Data Models): Federated SOC’s and shared threat intelligence only function if participating organisations share a common semantic understanding of security events, asset taxonomies, and risk classifications. Standardized ontologies (e.g., aligned with STIX/TAXII and MITRE ATT&CK) are a prerequisite for meaningful cross-border correlation.

CL3.6 Cyber Range & Digital Twin Federation for Security Validation: Before deploying cross-border federated security configurations into production, they must be validated in high-fidelity simulation environments. ENISA already coordinates national cyber range inventories; this cross-layer would federate them into a shared EU-wide infrastructure aligned with the Cyber Solidarity Act’s testing provisions.

Cross-Layer 4: Compliance-by-Design, Agile Governance & Automated Assurance

CL4.1 Policy-as-Code & Compliance-by-Design: Technical implementation of legal requirements (OSCAL) into machine-readable rules that pre-validate workloads.

CL4.2 Continuous Automated Auditing & Certification Lifecycle: Replacing “point-in-time” PDF certificates with real-time, telemetry-driven certification tracking for both cloud services (EUCS) [4] and physical ICT edge products (EUCC) [5]. This ensures that edge nodes autonomously maintain compliance by integrating mandatory vulnerability handling and cryptographic patch verification directly into their operational lifecycle, strictly aligning with EUCC maintenance and assurance rules [5].

CL4.3 Post-Quantum Readiness & Zero-Trust Architectures (ZTA): Moving beyond traditional perimeter-based defenses by embedding continuous, AI-driven Zero-Trust verification and micro-segmentation natively into the cloud-edge infrastructure,

combined with a systematic migration roadmap to post-quantum cryptographic primitives across all layers.

CL4.4 Continuous Automated Certification: Replacing “point-in-time” PDF certificates with real-time, telemetry-driven certification tracking for both cloud services (**EUCS**) and physical ICT edge products (**EUCC**), ensuring that edge nodes autonomously maintain compliance by integrating mandatory vulnerability handling and cryptographic patch verification directly into their operational lifecycle [5].

CL4.5 Multicloud Key Management as a Service (KMaaS): When AI workloads, data flows, and context flows migrate dynamically across a multi-provider computing continuum, managing cryptographic keys and access policies becomes highly complex. KMaaS provides a provider-agnostic, sovereign key lifecycle management capability that prevents key sprawl and ensures revocation propagates consistently across heterogeneous environments.

CL4.6 Privacy-Preserving Federated Computation: When multiple providers work on the same infrastructure, AI training and inference may require access to datasets stored across different jurisdictions and competitive boundaries. Privacy-preserving techniques (federated learning, differential privacy, SMPC) enable collaborative computation while guaranteeing that raw data never leaves its sovereign jurisdiction.

CL4.7 Cyber Risk Quantification & Board-Level Reporting (CRQ): Compliance frameworks define what controls to implement. A dedicated cross-layer translates technical security posture into financial and operational risk language for decision-makers—potentially in real-time—enabling boards to make informed, evidence-based investment and risk-acceptance decisions aligned with DORA requirements.

CL4.8 AI Trustworthiness & Algorithmic Accountability: As AI systems themselves become actors within the security architecture—making autonomous containment decisions, classifying threats, orchestrating responses—the trustworthiness of those AI systems becomes a security-critical concern. This layer defines explainability, auditability, and override mechanisms for AI-driven security functions, ensuring alignment with the EU AI Act for high-risk systems.

CL4.3 Regulatory Digital Twins: Virtualized replicas of critical infrastructure specifically to stress-test regulatory compliance against evolving laws before applying changes to the live physical continuum.

6 Priorities

6.1 Executive Priorities: The Critical Path (Phase 1)

Applying the 4-Filter Framework, the following areas are identified as immediate strategic priorities for the 2025-2030 funding cycle:

- **Priority 1:** Hardware Roots of Trust & EUCC ‘High’ Certification (Filters 1, 2, 3).
- **Priority 2:** Post-Quantum Cryptographic Agility for Edge/IoT (Filter 3).
- **Priority 3:** Lightweight Cryptography & Physical-Layer Security (PhySec) for the Extreme Edge.
- **Priority 4:** Security Interoperability via Simpl Middleware (Filter 4).

- **Priority 5:** Supply Chain Verification and Secured Infrastructure.
- **Priority 6:** Cognitive SecOps (LLMSecOps) & Automated Threat Intelligence.
- **Priority 7:** Pan-European NaaS Federation (“Schengen for Cloud-Edge/AI”).
- **Priority 8:** Confidential Computing & Privacy-Preserving AI Pipelines.
- **Priority 9:** Resilient-by-Design Infrastructure & Autonomous “Island Mode.”
- **Priority 10:** Proactive Cyber Threat Management & Defense against Advanced Persistent Threats (APTs).

7 Capability Profiles & Progression Matrices

Priority 1: Hardware Roots of Trust & EUCC ‘High’ Certification

1. **Baseline & Target Objective:** *Baseline:* High foreign dependency on proprietary Trusted Platform Modules (TPMs) and secure elements. Far-edge devices lack standardized hardware anchors. *Target:* Ubiquitous deployment of EU-designed, open-source (RISC-V) secure enclaves certified at **EUCC ‘High’ assurance**, providing a mathematically verifiable foundation for the entire continuum.
2. **Primary Drivers:** *Threat:* State-level physical tampering and side-channel attacks on decentralized edge nodes. *Regulatory:* Mandatory hardware security requirements under the **Cyber Resilience Act (CRA)** and certified anchors for **NIS2** critical infrastructure.
3. **High Impact Activities:** Development of sovereign European Secure Elements based on RISC-V; automated hardware-level remote attestation protocols for large-scale edge fleets; EU-level standard toolset developed and maintained by the European Commission; SME support for certification and compliance testing; security-based sensor research for future deployment.
4. **Catalysts & Enablers:** **EU Chips Act** pilot lines for secure silicon; **EU Strategic Agenda** funding for open-hardware security; alignment with CEN/CENELEC hardware security standards.
5. **Disruptors & Systemic Risks:** Supply chain bottlenecks for EU-based fabrication; breakthroughs in physical side-channel analysis that bypass current cryptographic enclaves.
6. **Failsafe Mechanisms & Resilience:** “Defense-in-depth” where software-based isolation (TEEs) acts as a secondary layer if a hardware enclave is compromised; autonomous node isolation and distributed attestation if hardware integrity is lost.
7. **Transversal Meta-Layer:** *Sovereignty:* Eliminates “black-box” hardware dependencies on non-EU vendors. *Sustainability:* Energy-efficient secure silicon designs reducing the carbon footprint of cryptographic operations at the far-edge.

Progression Matrix: Hardware Roots of Trust & EUCC 'High'

Metric	Phase 1: Foundation & Compliance (0-5 Yrs)	Phase 2: Federation & Standardization (5-10 Yrs)	Phase 3: Autonomy & Leadership (10-15 Yrs)
ODP	Fragmented Piloting	Standardized Integration	Ubiquitous Operation
SSL	High Foreign Dependency	Emerging EU Ecosystem	Full Sovereign Autonomy
Operational State	Cloud-based TPMs common; Edge nodes lack hardware trust; RISC-V pilots begin; CRA compliance starts.	Standardized EU-made secure elements in critical infra; Automated attestation at scale.	Sovereign hardware trust embedded by default in all EU ICT products from IoT to HPC.
Critical Enabler	Cyber Resilience Act (CRA) enforcement	EUCC 'High' certification of EU-based secure elements	Maturity of EU Chips Act sovereign fabrication lines

Priority 2: Post-Quantum Cryptographic (PQC) Agility for Edge/IoT

1. **Baseline & Target Objective:** *Baseline:* Current IoT and edge infrastructure predominantly relies on lightweight cryptography primitives which can be vulnerable to future quantum computers. Limited awareness and no systematic migration path for resource-constrained devices. *Target:* A “Quantum-Native” continuum where all critical edge/IoT infrastructure has migrated to hybrid or full Post-Quantum Cryptography, with automated crypto-agility enabling seamless algorithm updates without hardware replacement.
2. **Primary Drivers:** *Threat:* The **Q-Day** threat and “Harvest Now, Decrypt Later” strategies targeting sensitive long-lived data. *Regulatory:* Emerging ENISA guidelines and future EU mandates requiring PQC readiness for critical infrastructure under NIS2.
3. **High Impact Activities:** Optimization of NIST-standardized PQC algorithms for 8/16-bit microcontrollers; development of crypto-agility middleware for OTA algorithm updates; automated cryptographic inventory and migration tools for legacy IoT deployments; 3GPP specifications alignment for quantum key distribution (QKD) in cellular systems.
4. **Catalysts & Enablers:** Post-Quantum Cryptography standardization initiatives; **3GPP** specifications for quantum key distribution (QKD); **NIST PQC standardization finalization**; **ETSI** quantum-safe cryptography standards; **ENISA PQC guidelines**; **ECCC Strategic Agenda** funding; **EU Chips Act** for PQC-native silicon development.
5. **Disruptors & Systemic Risks:** Early arrival of CRQC before migration is complete; performance overhead of PQC algorithms on battery-powered IoT; fragmented standardization; insufficient cryptographic inventory of legacy OT/IoT systems.
6. **Failsafe Mechanisms & Resilience:** Deployment of hybrid cryptographic schemes (classical + PQC) during the transition; crypto-agility frameworks allowing rapid algorithm switching if vulnerabilities are discovered; diversification of PQC algorithm families to avoid single-point cryptanalytic failures.

7. **Transversal Meta-Layer: *Sovereignty*:** Protection of Europe’s long-term industrial and governmental secrets from future quantum decryption. *Sustainability:* Energy-efficient, lightweight PQC implementations reducing the carbon footprint of security (Green IT).

Progression Matrix: PQC Agility for Edge/IoT

Metric	Phase 1: Foundation & Compliance (0-5 Yrs)	Phase 2: Federation & Standardization (5-10 Yrs)	Phase 3: Autonomy & Leadership (10-15 Yrs)
ODP	Applied R&D	Fragmented Piloting	Ubiquitous Operation
SSL	High Foreign Dependency	Emerging EU Ecosystem	Full Sovereign Autonomy
Operational State	NIST algorithm selection; software-based PQC pilots in cloud environments; research on lightweight implementations.	Hybrid (classical + PQC) schemes in Industrial IoT and critical edge infrastructure; EU-developed crypto-agility middleware.	Fully quantum-resilient continuum with PQC embedded in all devices; automated crypto-agility across Cloud-Edge-IoT.
Critical Enabler	ENISA PQC Guidelines and NIST standardization completion	NIST/ETSI algorithm finalization and EU-wide deployment standards	PQC-native RISC-V silicon and ubiquitous crypto-agility frameworks

Priority 3: Lightweight Cryptography & Physical-Layer Security (PhySec) for the Extreme Edge

1. **Baseline & Target Objective:** *Baseline:* Massive IoT and nano-devices cannot support computationally heavy classical asymmetric encryption. Current security approaches are unsuitable for environments requiring 100 devices per m³ with 40-year battery lifespans or zero-energy backscatter radios. *Target:* Move to ultra-lightweight Post-Quantum Cryptography and keyless Physical-Layer Security (PhySec) embedded at the extreme edge, enabling security primitives that operate within severe energy and compute constraints.
2. **Primary Drivers:** *Threat:* The proliferation of massive Machine Type Communication (mMTC) creates an enormous unprotected attack surface; classical cryptography is both computationally infeasible and imminently vulnerable to quantum algorithms at the extreme edge. *Regulatory:* CRA requirements extend to the smallest connected devices; NIS2 mandates security across the full infrastructure including resource-constrained nodes.
3. **High Impact Activities:** Group-based authentication for large-scale constrained IoT fleets; RF fingerprinting and Channel State Information (CSI)-based device authentication; integration of lightweight PQC into European open-hardware (RISC-V) for smart body-area networks (WBAN); ETSI SmartBAN standardization alignment; research into “zero-energy” air interfaces with integrated Integrated Sensing and Communication (ISAC) security.
4. **Catalysts & Enablers:** NIST lightweight post-quantum cryptography standardization; ETSI SmartBAN standardization; 6G research into RF fingerprinting and

channel entropy for native security; Hardware-Software Co-Design for neuromorphic and Processing-in-Memory (PIM) architectures.

5. **Disruptors & Systemic Risks:** Performance gap between available energy budgets and minimum cryptographic processing requirements; fragmented device ecosystems preventing uniform PhySec adoption; lack of EU-manufactured ultra-constrained secure silicon.
6. **Failsafe Mechanisms & Resilience:** Dynamic fallback to localized, non-routed trust boundaries leveraging purely physical-layer signatures (RF fingerprinting or channel entropy) to authenticate devices if upper-layer cryptographic processing exceeds the available energy budget or is compromised.
7. **Transversal Meta-Layer:** *Sovereignty:* Sovereign control over the security of the most proliferated and currently most unprotected layer of the computing continuum. *Sustainability:* Zero-energy security primitives are inherently aligned with Green IT objectives and circular economy principles.

Progression Matrix: Lightweight Cryptography & PhySec for the Extreme Edge

Metric	Phase 1: Foundation & Compliance (0-5 Yrs)	Phase 2: Federation & Standardization (5-10 Yrs)	Phase 3: Autonomy & Leadership (10-15 Yrs)
ODP	Isolated Lightweight Piloting	Standardized D2D Security Integration	Ubiquitous Zero-Energy Trust
SSL	High Dependency on Legacy/Heavy Algorithms	Emerging EU Lightweight & Phy-Sec Ecosystem	Full Sovereign Extreme-Edge Cryptography
Operational State	Group-based authentication and early lightweight PQC algorithms tested on resource-constrained IoT; basic RF fingerprinting used for anomaly detection.	Lightweight PQC and PhySec natively embedded in European open-hardware (RISC-V) and smart body-area networks (WBAN).	Battery-less (zero-energy) nodes autonomously execute quantum-resistant authentication and trusted decentralized swarm communications.
Critical Enabler	NIST Lightweight PQC Standards & Context-Aware IoT Platforms	Hardware-Software Co-Design for Neuromorphic/PIM AI	“Zero-Energy” Air Interfaces & Ubiquitous ISAC (Integrated Sensing and Communication)

Priority 4: Security Interoperability via Simpl Middleware

1. **Baseline & Target Objective:** *Baseline:* Current European cloud and edge infrastructure is highly fragmented across proprietary vendor silos with incompatible security policies, authentication mechanisms, and data exchange protocols. This fragmentation prevents seamless data flow across Common European Data Spaces and creates vendor lock-in. *Target:* A unified European “Trust Fabric” enabling secure, federated interoperability across heterogeneous cloud and edge providers through mandatory integration with the **Simpl** open-source smart middleware stack, with standardized security Minimal Interoperability Mechanisms (MIMs).

2. **Primary Drivers:** *Regulatory:* **Data Act** mandates requiring seamless data portability and interoperability; requirements for Common European Data Spaces to operate across multiple providers; NIS2 requirements for coordinated incident response. *Market:* Breaking vendor lock-in to enable European SMEs to compete; enabling cross-border data flows while maintaining sovereignty.
3. **High Impact Activities:** Implementation and standardization of security-specific MIMs within the Simpl stack; automated policy translation engines converting provider-specific security policies into common machine-readable format (XACML, OSCAL); federated identity bridges using verifiable credentials; cross-domain security orchestration for unified threat response.
4. **Catalysts & Enablers:** **Digital Europe Programme** funding; **Simpl** open-source stack community and governance; **Gaia-X** federation services and trust frameworks; ECCC support for security MIM standardization.
5. **Disruptors & Systemic Risks:** Vendor resistance to open standards; weakest-link security failures in federated systems; complexity of policy translation creating semantic gaps; fragmented national implementations creating “data islands.”
6. **Failsafe Mechanisms & Resilience:** Capability to autonomously “unfederate” or isolate nodes that fail to meet the shared security baseline; zero-trust architectures where federation does not imply implicit trust; continuous compliance monitoring with automated ejection of non-compliant providers.
7. **Transversal Meta-Layer:** *Sovereignty:* Breaking dependence on non-EU hyper-scaler lock-in. *Trust:* Fostering pan-European cross-border trust through transparent, verifiable security mechanisms. *Economic Viability:* Enabling SMEs to participate in Data Spaces without massive infrastructure investments.

Progression Matrix: Security Interoperability via Simpl Middleware

Metric	Phase 1: Foundation & Compliance (0-5 Yrs)	Phase 2: Federation & Standardization (5-10 Yrs)	Phase 3: Autonomy & Leadership (10-15 Yrs)
ODP	Fragmented Piloting	Standardized Integration	Ubiquitous Operation
SSL	Emerging EU Ecosystem	Full Sovereign Autonomy	Full Sovereign Autonomy
Operational State	Initial Simpl security pilots in select Data Spaces; manual policy coordination; proof-of-concept MIM implementations.	Automated policy translation via standardized MIMs; Simpl-based security in majority of Common Data Spaces; cross-border federated SOC operations.	Fully automated, provider-agnostic European trust fabric; real-time security orchestration across the continuum; zero-trust federation by default.
Critical Enabler	Simpl-Open official launch and initial MIM definitions	Security MIMs adoption as CEN/CENELEC standards	EU Cloud Rulebook maturity and Data Act full enforcement

Priority 5: Supply Chain Verification and Secured Infrastructure

1. **Baseline & Target Objective:** *Baseline:* Supply chain tracking is static, opaque, and fragmented. The disaggregation of telco clouds (e.g., Open RAN) introduces

extreme complexity by mixing software and hardware from multiple vendors. SMEs lack resources to meet CRA and NIS2 supply chain compliance requirements. *Target:* Move to continuously verified ecosystems utilizing Runtime Software Bill of Materials (SBOMs), Digital Product Passports (DPP), and automated certification across multi-vendor deployments, with full supply chain transparency and sovereign control.

2. **Primary Drivers:** *Threat:* Sophisticated supply chain attacks (e.g., SolarWinds-style compromises) targeting the disaggregated Open RAN and cloud-edge ecosystem; hidden backdoors in non-EU hardware and firmware. *Regulatory:* Strict legal mandates from the **Cyber Resilience Act (CRA)** and **NIS2 Directive** demanding robust supply chain risk management; Digital Product Passport (DPP) initiatives for traceability.
3. **High Impact Activities:** Review and mapping of hardware, OS, and software supply chain vulnerabilities; SME engagement prioritized—ensuring one-size-fits-all approaches are avoided and SMEs can enable new technology integration (e.g., NXP ecosystems); Dynamic Runtime SBOMs tracking active component states; Digital Product Passports for end-to-end traceability; Zero-Knowledge Proofs (ZKPs) for IP-protected component verification.
4. **Catalysts & Enablers:** Digital Product Passport (DPP) initiatives; European financial support for SME security upskilling; ECCC strategic funding for supply chain security tooling; Pan-European threat intelligence sharing for supply chain indicators of compromise.
5. **Disruptors & Systemic Risks:** Extreme complexity of multi-vendor Open RAN supply chains; geopolitical dependencies on non-EU component manufacturers; SMEs being priced out of compliance; lack of standardized machine-readable supply chain attestation formats.
6. **Failsafe Mechanisms & Resilience:** Graceful isolation of unverified or high-risk components into quarantined network slices until cryptographic proofs of execution can validate their integrity; automated blocking of unverified components in production deployments.
7. **Transversal Meta-Layer:** *Sovereignty:* Reducing systemic dependency on non-EU hardware and software supply chains. *Trust:* Providing verifiable, transparent provenance for all components in the European computing continuum. *Economic:* Protecting EU industrial IP through privacy-preserving verification mechanisms.

Progression Matrix: Supply Chain Verification and Secured Infrastructure

Metric	Phase 1: Foundation & Compliance (0-5 Yrs)	Phase 2: Federation & Standardization (5-10 Yrs)	Phase 3: Autonomy & Leadership (10-15 Yrs)
ODP	Full Supply Chain Disclosure	Partial Restriction Process	Full Restriction Process
SSL	High Reliance on Fragmented, Non-EU Supply Chain Auditing	Emerging EU Supply Chain Tracking Frameworks (DPP)	Full Sovereign Control and Supply Chain Transparency
Operational State	Review of hardware, OS, and software supply chain vulnerabilities; initial Runtime SBOM pilots; CRA compliance mapping begins.	Ensuring certification of critical supply chain hardware, OS, and software; DPP frameworks operational; SME compliance pathways established.	Fully certified supply chain actively blocking unverified components; ZKPs enable IP-protected verification at continental scale.
Critical Enabler	CRA supply chain requirements enforcement; SME engagement programme	Dynamic Runtime SBOMs and Digital Product Passports	Zero-Knowledge Proofs (ZKPs) & Pan-European Threat Intel sharing

Priority 6: Cognitive SecOps (LLMSecOps) & Automated Threat Intelligence

1. **Baseline & Target Objective:** *Baseline:* Security Operations Centers (SOCs) are predominantly manual, reactive, and siloed. Analyst capacity is far outpaced by the expanding attack surface of 5G/6G and the millions of IoT devices. EU SOCs are heavily reliant on non-EU AI foundation models. *Target:* Autonomous, AI-driven “LLMSecOps” agents distributed across the 6G edge, capable of proactive threat hunting, real-time incident containment, and continuous learning without requiring human intervention for routine responses.
2. **Primary Drivers:** *Threat:* The dual-use nature of AI generating complex offensive threats (APTs, data poisoning, AI-driven exploit generation); the expanding attack surface of 6G and millions of IoT devices overwhelming human-scale SOC operations. *Regulatory:* EU AI Act compliance for high-risk autonomous security systems; Zero-Touch Network & Service Management (ZSM) goals; EuroHPC AI Factories as the compute substrate for sovereign AI models.
3. **High Impact Activities:** LLM-assisted human SOC analysts integrated with NWDAF telemetry; edge-native “Guardian” nodes executing Zero-Trust reconfigurations autonomously; European sovereign Small Language Models (SLMs) for security classification; swarm-based agentic AI for decentralized threat intelligence; standardized AI Interconnect APIs.
4. **Catalysts & Enablers:** EU AI Act compliance frameworks for high-risk security AI; EuroHPC AI Factories providing compute for sovereign foundation model training; ECCC Strategic Agenda for LLMSecOps standardization; NWDAF integration with 3GPP standards.
5. **Disruptors & Systemic Risks:** AI hallucination causing false containment actions disrupting critical services; adversarial attacks on the AI models themselves (prompt injection, model poisoning); regulatory uncertainty around autonomous AI

decision-making in security contexts; continued dominance of non-EU foundation models.

6. **Failsafe Mechanisms & Resilience:** “Shadow-mode” rollback and human-in-the-loop (RLHF) intervention if autonomous edge agents hallucinate or exhibit unstable control loops; mandatory override mechanisms for all autonomous security decisions affecting critical infrastructure.
7. **Transversal Meta-Layer:** *Sovereignty:* Development of European sovereign edge LLMs and SLMs replacing dependency on US foundation models. *Trust:* Ensuring that AI-driven security decisions are explainable, auditable, and aligned with the EU AI Act for high-risk systems. *Sustainability:* Energy-efficient edge AI inference reducing the carbon footprint of autonomous security operations.

Progression Matrix: Cognitive SecOps (LLMSecOps) & Automated Threat Intelligence

Metric	Phase 1: Foundation & Compliance (0-5 Yrs)	Phase 2: Federation & Standardization (5-10 Yrs)	Phase 3: Autonomy & Leadership (10-15 Yrs)
ODP	Siloed AI Copilots	Federated Edge Agents	Ubiquitous AI Immune System
SSL	High Reliance on US Foundation Models	Sovereign European Edge LLMs, SLMs, LCMs	Global Leadership in Trustworthy AI
Operational State	LLMs assist human SOC analysts; NWDAF telemetry routed to centralized AI for anomaly detection.	Edge-native “Guardian” nodes autonomously execute Zero-Trust reconfigurations and throttle threats.	Swarm-based agentic AI defends the Edge-Cloud Continuum via decentralized, proactive threat intelligence.
Critical Enabler	EU AI Act enforcement & EuroHPC AI Factories	Standardized AI Interconnect APIs	Self-Evolving AI Swarm Protocols

Priority 7: Pan-European NaaS Federation (“Schengen for Cloud-Edge/AI”)

1. **Baseline & Target Objective:** *Baseline:* European telco deployments are fragmented and nation-bound. The lack of a true Digital Single Market prevents European operators from scaling to compete with US and Chinese hyperscalers. *Target:* A unified, interoperable European Network-as-a-Service (NaaS) platform enabling seamless “roaming for compute” across borders, legally operating as a single jurisdiction for data workloads.
2. **Primary Drivers:** *Market:* The “Sovereignty Cliff”—lack of a true Digital Single Market prevents European operators from achieving scale parity with hyperscalers. *Regulatory:* Data Act interoperability requirements; IPCEI-CIS mandates for cross-border infrastructure investment; CAMARA API standardization enabling federated network services.
3. **High Impact Activities:** Deployment of harmonized CAMARA APIs; automated compliance negotiation in 5G corridors; “Data Visa” mechanisms enabling dynamic

cross-border AI model migration; inter-operator East-West security interfaces; development of the “Schengen for Cloud” legal framework.

4. **Catalysts & Enablers:** IPCEI-CIS initial deployments; **European Alliance for Industrial Data, Edge and Cloud**; **CAMARA API alliance**; **Gaia-X** federation services; **ECCC** for cross-border security standards.
5. **Disruptors & Systemic Risks:** Conflicting national data sovereignty laws preventing true federation; regulatory arbitrage creating security-weakest-link vulnerabilities at cross-border interfaces; insufficient SLA enforcement mechanisms across operator boundaries.
6. **Failsafe Mechanisms & Resilience:** Graceful degradation protocols redirect workloads to national infrastructure if cross-border SLAs or compliance APIs fail; bilateral fallback agreements between operator pairs ensuring minimum viable connectivity.
7. **Transversal Meta-Layer:** *Sovereignty:* Enabling European-scale infrastructure that competes with US and Chinese hyperscalers without ceding control to non-EU providers. *Trust:* “Data Visas” providing legal clarity on data jurisdiction during cross-border migration. *Economic:* Creating a genuine Digital Single Market that enables European SMEs and operators to compete at continental scale.

Progression Matrix: Pan-European NaaS Federation

Metric	Phase 1: Foundation & Compliance (0-5 Yrs)	Phase 2: Federation & Standardization (5-10 Yrs)	Phase 3: Autonomy & Leadership (10-15 Yrs)
ODP	Bilateral Interconnection	Federated Edge Roaming	True Digital Single Market
SSL	Hyperscaler Platform Dominance	Pan-European Consortium Competes	European Scale Parity Achieved
Operational State	Harmonized CAMARA APIs deployed; Automated Compliance Negotiators tested in 5G corridors.	“Data Visas” enable dynamic cross-border migration of AI models without legal friction.	Single unified computing continuum legally operates as one jurisdiction for data workloads.
Critical Enabler	IPCEI-CIS Initial Deployments	Inter-Operator East-West Interfaces	“Schengen for Cloud” Legal Framework

Priority 8: Confidential Computing & Privacy-Preserving AI Pipelines

1. **Baseline & Target Objective:** *Baseline:* Basic encryption at-rest and in-transit is standard, but data-in-use remains exposed during processing. Multi-tenant edge nodes and federated AI training create significant insider threat and IP leakage risks. *Target:* Ubiquitous data-in-use protection via Trusted Execution Environments (TEEs) and Homomorphic Encryption across the full Cloud-to-IoT path, enabling collaborative AI without raw data ever leaving sovereign jurisdictions.
2. **Primary Drivers:** *Threat:* Insider threats in multi-tenant edge nodes; IP exfiltration during federated AI training across competitive organizational boundaries.

Regulatory: **GDPR** stringency for data-in-use; **EUCS “High+”** certification requirements mandating confidential computing for sensitive cloud workloads; **AI Act** requirements for data governance in high-risk AI systems.

3. **High Impact Activities:** TEE deployment on critical cloud nodes for EUCS compliance; sovereign hardware pilots using EU-developed RISC-V TEEs; multi-party privacy-preserving AI pipelines across multi-provider nodes; operationalization of Fully Homomorphic Encryption (FHE) for production analytics workloads.
4. **Catalysts & Enablers:** **EUCS** Certification Rollout; **European Data Spaces** as the deployment vehicle; **Chips JU** for RISC-V hardware development; **ECCC** strategic funding for FHE maturation.
5. **Disruptors & Systemic Risks:** TEE side-channel vulnerabilities rendering current enclave implementations obsolete; FHE performance overhead remaining prohibitive for real-time edge applications; continued dependency on non-EU TEE hardware (Intel SGX, ARM TrustZone).
6. **Failsafe Mechanisms & Resilience:** Limit processing to local, on-device federated learning nodes (never sharing raw data) if edge TEE integrity cannot be cryptographically verified; multi-TEE implementation diversity to avoid single-vendor hardware vulnerabilities.
7. **Transversal Meta-Layer:** *Sovereignty:* Moving from reliance on foreign hardware TEEs to sovereign RISC-V TEEs. *Trust:* Enabling European citizens and businesses to share data for AI without sacrificing privacy. *Ethics:* Providing the technical foundation for Privacy-by-Design as required by GDPR.

Progression Matrix: Confidential Computing & Privacy-Preserving AI Pipelines

Metric	Phase 1: Foundation & Compliance (0-5 Yrs)	Phase 2: Federation & Standardization (5-10 Yrs)	Phase 3: Autonomy & Leadership (10-15 Yrs)
ODP	Isolated Enclaves	Distributed Confidential Cloud	Ubiquitous Confidential Continuum
SSL	High Reliance on Foreign Hardware TPMs	European RISC-V TEEs Emerge	Total Data-in-Use Sovereignty
Operational State	TEEs deployed on critical cloud nodes for EUCS compliance; initial sovereign hardware pilots.	Multi-party privacy-preserving AI pipelines train across multi-provider nodes seamlessly.	Homomorphic encryption operationalized; end-to-end encrypted continuum from IoT to HPC.
Critical Enabler	EUCS Certification Rollout	RISC-V Hardware Scaling	Fully Homomorphic Encryption (FHE) Maturation

Priority 9: Resilient-by-Design Infrastructure & Autonomous “Island Mode”

1. **Baseline & Target Objective:** *Baseline:* Current cloud-dependent architectures have single points of failure. Edge nodes cannot function autonomously if WAN

connectivity or centralized cloud services are disrupted. NIS2 mandates business continuity but infrastructure lacks native resilience capabilities. *Target:* Edge-native architectures capable of graceful degradation and autonomous local operation (“Island Mode”) during severe network, cloud, or power disruptions—ensuring continuity of critical services without any central cloud intervention.

2. **Primary Drivers:** *Threat:* Escalating global stressors—cyberattacks, extreme weather, geopolitical tensions—causing cascading failures across interconnected cloud-edge infrastructure. *Regulatory:* **NIS2** mandates for business continuity in critical infrastructures (healthcare, energy, transport); **DORA** (Digital Operational Resilience Act) requirements for financial sector; SNS JU requirements for 6G resilience and AI-RAN.
3. **High Impact Activities:** Edge node soft-state protocols enabling operation with cached credentials during cloud disconnections; AI-driven anomaly detection triggering graceful degradation automatically; dynamic spectrum sharing for emergency roaming; zero-energy backup layers maintaining minimal vital telemetry; bio-inspired elasticity for autonomous E2E recovery.
4. **Catalysts & Enablers:** **NIS2 & DORA** Enforcement as market driver; **3GPP/ETSI** standardized fallback APIs; **SNS JU** 6G resilience research; **O-RAN** distributed open interfaces enabling autonomous RAN operation.
5. **Disruptors & Systemic Risks:** Security vulnerabilities introduced by offline-mode cached credentials being exploited; lack of standardized Island Mode protocols preventing interoperability during coordinated multi-site disruptions; power infrastructure failures disabling edge nodes before Island Mode activates.
6. **Failsafe Mechanisms & Resilience:** Zero-energy backup layers or localized Low-Power WAN (LPWAN) micro-slices maintaining a “minimal viable network” for life-saving telemetry if standard edge power and computing completely fail; local cryptographic credential caches with time-bounded validity to prevent indefinite offline operation.
7. **Transversal Meta-Layer:** *Sovereignty:* Ensuring European critical infrastructure can operate independently of any centralized or foreign-hosted cloud dependency. *Trust:* Guaranteeing continuity of essential services for European citizens during crises. *Sustainability:* Ultra-low-power Island Mode operation aligning resilience with Green IT objectives.

Progression Matrix: Resilient-by-Design Infrastructure & Autonomous “Island Mode”

Metric	Phase 1: Foundation & Compliance (0-5 Yrs)	Phase 2: Federation & Standardization (5-10 Yrs)	Phase 3: Autonomy & Leadership (10-15 Yrs)
ODP	Localized Fallback Piloting	Standardized Island Mode	Fully Autonomous Cyber-Physical Resilience
SSL	Vulnerable to Cascading WAN Failures	Contained Local Survivability	Systemic European Resilience
Operational State	Edge nodes use cached credentials and soft-state protocols to survive temporary cloud disconnections.	AI-driven anomaly detection triggers graceful degradation; dynamic spectrum sharing used for emergency roaming.	Bio-inspired elasticity; swarms seamlessly coordinate E2E cyber-physical recovery without any central cloud intervention.
Critical Enabler	NIS2 & DORA Enforcement	3GPP/ETSI Standardized Fallback APIs	“Cognitive Twin” E2E Orchestration

Priority 10: Proactive Cyber Threat Management & Defense against Advanced Persistent Threats (APTs)

1. **Baseline & Target Objective:** *Baseline:* Intrusion Detection Systems are reactive with long “dwell times,” allowing APTs to persist undetected for months. Threat intelligence is siloed, national, and non-standardized. Incident response relies heavily on manual analyst workflows. *Target:* Proactive, AI-driven cyber threat hunting, multi-layered alert correlation, and dynamic Moving Target Defense (MTD) to disrupt the prolonged lifecycles of state-sponsored APTs before they achieve their objectives.
2. **Primary Drivers:** *Threat:* The increasing sophistication of nation-state actors blending cyber espionage with organized crime; exploitation of complex supply chains (e.g., SolarWinds-style attacks); use of stealthy techniques like memory-only execution and legitimate administrative tools (“living off the land”) for lateral movement. *Regulatory:* NIS2 incident reporting timelines requiring faster detection and response; ECCC mandate for Pan-European Cyber Threat Intelligence (CTI) sharing.
3. **High Impact Activities:** SIEM/ML correlation of seemingly isolated events to reduce APT dwell times; machine-assisted threat hunting for Indicators of Compromise (IoCs) aligned with MITRE ATT&CK; LLMSecOps agents autonomously ingesting CTI and tracking anomalous lateral movement; AI-driven Moving Target Defense (MTD) continuously shuffling network resources and IP addresses to disrupt reconnaissance.
4. **Catalysts & Enablers:** MITRE ATT&CK framework integration into automated incident management; Machine Learning and **User and Entity Behavior Analytics (UEBA)** for continuous threat hunting; Pan-European CTI sharing platforms (CONCORDIA successor); ECCC coordination of national cyber intelligence capacities.
5. **Disruptors & Systemic Risks:** APT actors adapting faster than defensive AI can learn, using adversarial techniques to evade ML-based detection; legal barriers

to real-time CTI sharing across Member State jurisdictions; AI-generated malware bypassing behavioral baselines trained on historical attack patterns.

6. **Failsafe Mechanisms & Resilience:** Autonomous, real-time micro-segmentation (Zero-Trust) to instantly quarantine compromised supply chain components or sever Command and Control (C&C) pathways as soon as behavioral anomalies are detected, even if the specific zero-day exploit is unknown.
7. **Transversal Meta-Layer:** *Sovereignty:* Building European sovereign threat intelligence capacity reducing dependency on non-EU threat feeds and analysis platforms. *Trust:* Protecting European public institutions, critical infrastructure, and democratic processes from state-sponsored cyber operations. *Resilience:* Ensuring that even the most sophisticated adversaries face a continually shifting, proactive defense rather than a static target.

Progression Matrix: Proactive Cyber Threat Management & Defense against APTs

Metric	Phase 1: Foundation & Compliance (0-5 Yrs)	Phase 2: Federation & Standardization (5-10 Yrs)	Phase 3: Autonomy & Leadership (10-15 Yrs)
ODP	Multi-Layered Alert Correlation & Hunting	Automated Triage & LLMSecOps Containment	Ubiquitous Moving Target Defense (MTD)
SSL	High Dependency on Global Threat Feeds	Sovereign Pan-European CTI & Behavioral Analytics	Full Autonomous Counter-Adversarial Resilience
Operational State	SIEM systems and ML correlate isolated events to reduce APT dwell times; analysts conduct machine-assisted threat hunting for IoCs.	LLMSecOps agents autonomously ingest CTI, track anomalous lateral movement, and orchestrate rapid incident triage aligned with MITRE ATT&CK.	AI-driven MTD continuously shuffles network resources, IP addresses, and software diversity, actively disrupting APT reconnaissance and paralyzing attacks.
Critical Enabler	Federated SIEMs & Standardized CTI Sharing Protocols	LLMSecOps & UEBA (User and Entity Behavior Analytics)	Adaptive Edge-Cloud AI Swarms & Zero-Touch Automation

8 Executive Summary & Strategic Recommendations

Executive Summary

This cybersecurity and cyber-resilience strategy defines a comprehensive 15-year trajectory to secure the European Cloud-Edge-IoT Continuum against emerging threats while establishing digital sovereignty. The strategy moves beyond traditional perimeter defenses toward autonomous, federated, and certified Security-by-Design architectures.

By utilizing a **4-Filter Prioritization Framework** (Regulatory Urgency, Foundational Dependency, Sovereignty Cliff, and Market Feasibility), we identify ten strategic priorities across three phases: **Foundation & Compliance (2025–2030)**, **Federation & Standardization (2030–2035)**, and **Autonomy & Leadership (2035–2040)**.

The roadmap employs a dual-metric progression framework: **Operational Deployment Phase (ODP)** tracking market integration, and **Strategic Sovereignty Level (SSL)** measuring European independence from foreign technology dependencies.

Strategic Recommendations for Phase 1 (2025–2030)

- **Accelerate Sovereign Secure Silicon Development:** Immediate Horizon Europe and EU Chips Act funding for open-source RISC-V secure elements engineered to meet **EUCC 'High' assurance levels**. Establish pilot fabrication lines to reduce 100% foreign dependency on TPMs and secure enclaves.
- **Operationalize Crypto-Agility for the Edge/IoT:** Develop and standardize automated crypto-agility middleware allowing resource-constrained IoT devices to upgrade to **Post-Quantum Cryptography** without hardware replacement. Prioritize ENISA guidelines alignment and lightweight PQC for 8/16-bit microcontrollers.
- **Extend PhySec to the Extreme Edge:** Fund R&I into physical-layer security primitives (RF fingerprinting, CSI-based authentication) for zero-energy and battery-less devices that cannot support computational cryptography, ensuring security coverage across the full IoT spectrum.
- **Enforce Security-by-Design via Simpl Integration:** Mandate standardized security **Minimal Interoperability Mechanisms (MIMs)** across all Common European Data Spaces to ensure provider-agnostic, cryptographically verifiable security policies eliminating vendor lock-in.
- **Operationalize CRA-Compliant Supply Chain Transparency:** Mandate Runtime SBOMs and Digital Product Passports for all ICT products entering the EU market; provide targeted SME support to prevent compliance costs creating discriminatory market barriers.
- **Deploy Sovereign LLMSecOps Capabilities:** Invest in EuroHPC AI Factories for training sovereign European security foundation models, reducing dependency on US LLMs for critical SOC operations. Mandate human-in-the-loop overrides for all autonomous security decisions in critical infrastructure.

- **Launch NaaS Federation Pilots:** Deploy CAMARA-harmonized API corridors across 3-5 Member States as the foundation for the “Schengen for Cloud/AI” vision, building the legal and technical architecture for true cross-border compute roaming.
- **Harmonize Continuous Certification Lifecycles:** Transition from static, point-in-time audits to **Continuous Automated Assurance** frameworks with real-time telemetry-driven compliance tracking for both **EUCS** (cloud) and **EUCC** (edge products).
- **Synchronize Regulatory Enforcement Timelines:** Ensure coordinated enforcement of NIS2, CRA, and AI Act requirements by 2026–2027 to create unified market incentives for security investment across all ten priority areas.

Success Metrics for 2030

By the end of Phase 1, Europe should achieve:

- **Hardware Sovereignty:** At least 30% of critical infrastructure edge nodes utilizing EU-designed, EUCC 'High' certified secure elements.
- **Quantum Readiness:** 100% of new critical IoT deployments supporting hybrid PQC schemes; complete cryptographic inventory of legacy systems.
- **Extreme-Edge Security:** Standardized lightweight PQC and PhySec primitives available for ultra-constrained IoT platforms.
- **Federated Trust:** Majority of Common European Data Spaces operating on Simpl-based security interoperability with standardized MIMs.
- **Supply Chain Transparency:** Runtime SBOMs and DPPs mandated and operational for all new critical ICT deployments.
- **AI-Augmented SOC:** LLMSecOps copilots deployed in 10+ national CERT/SOC environments; first sovereign EU security SLMs operational.
- **Certification Maturity:** Operational continuous certification frameworks for at least two major Data Spaces with real-time EUCS/EUCC tracking.

A Master Prompt for Generating Capability Profiles

Context for Content Generation

You are an expert EU Cybersecurity Policy Strategist and Technical Architect. Your task is to populate capability profiles for the European Cloud-Edge-IoT Cybersecurity Roadmap using the structured framework defined in this document. Each capability profile must be rigorously aligned with European strategic autonomy goals, regulatory requirements, and the specific needs of the distributed computing continuum.

Input Requirements

Before generating a capability profile, ensure you have:

- **Capability Name:** Clear, concise identifier (e.g., “Zero-Trust Network Architecture for Edge”)
- **Architectural Placement:** Which Layer(s) or Cross-Layer(s) does this capability belong to? (Refer to Section 4)
- **Priority Justification:** Which filters from the 4-Filter Framework does this capability satisfy? (Section 5)
- **Contextual Scope:** Is this capability specific to HPC, Cloud, Edge, or Devices? Or does it span multiple environments?

Generation Template: 7-Dimensional Analysis

For each capability, generate a complete analysis following this exact structure:

Dimension 1: Baseline & Target Objective

- **Baseline (Current State):** Describe the state of the art in Europe as of 2025-2026. Include:
 - Current ODP level (Applied R&D / Fragmented Piloting / Standardized Integration)
 - Current SSL level (High Foreign Dependency / Emerging EU Ecosystem / Full Sovereign Autonomy)
 - Specific technical/economic barriers preventing immediate adoption
 - Market fragmentation or vendor lock-in issues
- **Target (Desired State by 2040):** Define success. Include:
 - Target ODP: Ubiquitous Operation across the continuum
 - Target SSL: Full Sovereign Autonomy with quantified EU market share (e.g., “60% of edge secure elements are EU-designed”)
 - Measurable technical outcomes (e.g., “100% of critical IoT devices support PQC”)

Dimension 2: Primary Drivers

- **Threat Drivers:** What adversarial capabilities or attack vectors make this urgent?
 - Examples: Side-channel attacks on edge TPMs, quantum decryption threats, AI-driven exploit automation
- **Regulatory Drivers:** Which EU laws mandate or incentivize this capability?
 - Cite specific directives: NIS2 Article X, CRA Annex Y, AI Act requirements
 - Include enforcement timelines (e.g., “NIS2 full enforcement by October 2024”)

Dimension 3: High Impact Activities

List 3-5 specific technical interventions that will yield the greatest strategic ROI:

- Be concrete: “Develop automated TEE attestation for heterogeneous edge fleets” (not “Improve edge security”)
- Prioritize activities that unlock multiple downstream capabilities
- Indicate which activities target Phase 1 vs. Phase 2-3

Dimension 4: Catalysts & Enablers

- **Funding Alignment:** Which Horizon Europe clusters, Digital Europe Programme calls, or ECCC work packages should fund this? Reference the **ECCC Strategic Agenda** explicitly.
- **Standardization:** Which CEN/CENELEC, ETSI, or ISO standards are required? Are they existing or need development?
- **Ecosystem Enablers:** Pilot infrastructure (e.g., federated Cyber Ranges), industry partnerships (e.g., Gaia-X integration), SME support schemes.

Dimension 5: Disruptors & Systemic Risks

Identify severe risks that could derail the roadmap:

- **Technical Cliffs:** Examples: Q-Day arriving before PQC migration; breakthrough in TEE side-channel attacks rendering current enclaves obsolete
- **Market & Supply Chain:** Examples: EU Chips Act fabrication delays; vendor resistance to open standards; monopolization by non-EU providers
- **Geopolitical:** Examples: Export controls on critical components; extra-territorial jurisdiction conflicts

Dimension 6: Failsafe Mechanisms & Resilience

Define engineering fallbacks if the primary capability fails:

- **Redundancy:** Hybrid approaches (e.g., classical + PQC crypto during transition)
- **Graceful Degradation:** How does the system continue operating in a compromised state?
- **Autonomous Isolation:** Automated quarantine protocols for compromised nodes
- **Implementation Diversity:** Avoid monocultures (e.g., deploy multiple TEE technologies, not just one vendor)

Dimension 7: Transversal Meta-Layer

Connect the technical capability to overarching EU policy goals:

- **Sovereignty & Autonomy:** How does this reduce extra-territorial dependencies?
- **Trust & Ethics:** How does this uphold GDPR principles, Privacy-by-Design, algorithmic transparency?
- **Sustainability (Green IT):** Energy efficiency, e-waste reduction, circular economy alignment

Generation Template: Progression Matrix

After completing the 7-Dimensional Analysis, generate a progression matrix with this structure:

- **Row 1 - ODP:** Applied R&D → Fragmented Piloting → Standardized Integration → Ubiquitous Operation
- **Row 2 - SSL:** High Foreign Dependency → Emerging EU Ecosystem → Full Sovereign Autonomy
- **Row 3 - Operational State:** 2-3 sentence snapshot of “what’s happening on the ground” in this phase
- **Row 4 - Critical Enabler:** The single most important regulation, standard, or R&I breakthrough required to transition to the next phase

Mandatory Integration Points

All generated profiles MUST reference:

- **Simpl Middleware:** If the capability involves cross-provider interoperability or Data Spaces (CL3.1)
- **SNS JU SRIA:** If the capability involves 5G/6G, network slicing, or telco-cloud (Layer 6.1)

- **EUCS/EUCC:** If the capability involves certification, compliance automation, or assurance (CL4.2)
- **ECCC Strategic Agenda:** All profiles must align funding recommendations with ECCC priorities

Tone & Style Requirements

- **Evaluator-Grade Rigor:** Assume the audience includes European Commission evaluators, national cybersecurity directors, and technical auditors
- **Actionable Specificity:** Avoid generic statements; provide concrete activities, timelines, and funding mechanisms
- **Evidence-Based:** Cite regulations, standardization efforts, and existing EU initiatives
- **Balanced Realism:** Acknowledge risks and uncertainties; avoid over-promising on speculative technologies

B Execution Roadmap for Implementation

Overview

This chapter provides a step-by-step execution framework for translating the strategic priorities identified in this roadmap into actionable R&I projects, policy measures, and industrial deployments across the 2025-2040 timeline.

Phase 1: Foundation & Compliance (2025-2030)

Year 1-2 (2025-2026): Strategic Alignment & Pilot Initiation

Policy & Governance Actions:

- Establish inter-DG coordination mechanism (DG CONNECT, DG CNECT, ECCC) for unified cybersecurity investment strategy
- Finalize and publish EU-wide PQC migration guidelines (ENISA lead)
- Launch Simpl Governance Board with security workstream mandate
- Issue Horizon Europe calls explicitly aligned with Priority 1-3 (Hardware RoT, PQC, Simpl)

R&I & Technology Actions:

- Fund 3-5 RISC-V secure element pilot projects targeting EUCC 'High' certification
- Initiate PQC optimization research for 8/16-bit microcontrollers (embedded systems focus)
- Deploy Simpl security MIM pilots in 2-3 Data Spaces (e.g., Manufacturing, Health)
- Establish federated Cyber Range infrastructure for cross-border SOC training

Success Metrics:

- At least 50M EUR allocated to sovereign secure silicon R&D
- ENISA PQC guidelines published and adopted by 5+ Member States
- 2+ Common Data Spaces operationally testing Simpl security modules

Year 3-4 (2027-2028): Standardization & Scale-Up

Policy & Governance Actions:

- Enforce CRA compliance verification for all new IoT/edge products entering EU market
- Publish CEN/CENELEC standards for security MIMs and crypto-agility frameworks
- Establish continuous certification pilot programs for EUCS/EUCC (replace point-in-time audits)

- Launch EU Chips Act secure silicon fabrication pilot lines

R&I & Technology Actions:

- Transition RISC-V secure elements from TRL 6-7 to industrial production (TRL 8-9)
- Deploy hybrid PQC schemes in critical infrastructure (energy grids, financial systems)
- Scale Simpl-based security across 50%+ of active Common Data Spaces
- Operationalize automated SOC federation with cross-border threat intelligence sharing (CONCORDIA successor)

Success Metrics:

- First EU-manufactured EUCC 'High' certified secure elements in production
- 30% of new critical IoT deployments support hybrid (classical + PQC) cryptography
- Simpl security MIMs adopted as official CEN standard

Year 5 (2029-2030): Market Penetration & Assessment

Policy & Governance Actions:

- Conduct comprehensive Phase 1 evaluation against 2030 success metrics (Section 10)
- Issue Phase 2 funding strategy based on Phase 1 outcomes and emerging threats
- Mandate PQC support for all new public sector ICT procurement

R&I & Technology Actions:

- Achieve 30%+ market share for EU secure silicon in critical edge infrastructure
- Complete cryptographic inventory of 80%+ legacy OT/IoT systems (PQC migration readiness)
- Demonstrate fully automated, real-time EUCC/EUCC certification tracking in operational Data Space

Success Metrics:

- SSL metric: Transition from “High Foreign Dependency” to “Emerging EU Ecosystem” for Priority 1
- ODP metric: Transition from “Fragmented Piloting” to “Standardized Integration” for Priorities 2-3

Phase 2: Federation & Standardization (2030-2035)

Strategic Focus Areas

- **Quantum-Resilient Continuum:** Complete PQC migration for all critical infrastructure; deprecate classical-only cryptography in high-security contexts
- **Autonomous Security Orchestration:** Deploy AI-driven, zero-trust policy enforcement across federated Cloud-Edge ecosystems
- **European Certification Fabric:** Ubiquitous continuous certification with automated compliance verification for NIS2/CRA/AI Act
- **Sovereign Supply Chains:** Achieve 60%+ EU market share for secure silicon; establish resilient fabrication capacity

Key Execution Milestones

- 2031: NIST PQC algorithm finalization triggers mandatory adoption timelines
- 2032: EU-wide deployment of PQC-native RISC-V processors in new edge infrastructure
- 2033: Simpl-based security standard becomes mandatory for all EU-funded cloud/edge projects
- 2034: First “Quantum-Safe Data Space” fully operational with end-to-end PQC
- 2035: Phase 2 completion assessment; 70%+ Data Spaces using automated policy federation

Phase 3: Autonomy & Leadership (2035-2040)

Strategic Vision

Establish Europe as the global leader in secure, sovereign, and sustainable computing continuum infrastructure. Achieve:

- **Full Sovereign Autonomy (SSL):** EU-designed security components dominate European market; zero critical dependencies on extra-territorial providers
- **Ubiquitous Operation (ODP):** Security-by-Design is the default; manual security configuration is obsolete
- **Export Leadership:** European cybersecurity standards and technologies become global reference implementations

Key Execution Milestones

- 2036: European “Quantum-Native” computing continuum fully operational
- 2037: 100% of EU Common Data Spaces operate on provider-agnostic, zero-trust architectures

- 2038: Continuous automated certification becomes global best practice (EU-led standardization)
- 2039: EU Chips Act sovereign fabrication meets 80%+ of European secure silicon demand
- 2040: Roadmap completion assessment; initiate next-generation strategy for post-quantum, neuromorphic, and space-based edge computing security

Cross-Phase Execution Principles

Continuous Monitoring & Adaptation

- **Annual Reviews:** ECCC-led assessment of ODP/SSL progression against roadmap targets
- **Threat Landscape Updates:** Quarterly intelligence briefs on emerging attack vectors requiring roadmap adjustments
- **Technology Watch:** Monitor adversarial R&I (e.g., quantum computing breakthroughs) and adjust timelines accordingly

Stakeholder Coordination

- **Public-Private Partnerships:** Formalize collaboration frameworks between ECCC, national agencies, and industry consortia
- **SME Inclusion:** Dedicated support programs ensuring SMEs can participate without discriminatory certification/compliance costs
- **Academic Integration:** Align university curricula with roadmap skill requirements (PQC, TEE development, federated security)

Risk Mitigation & Resilience

- **Failfast Protocols:** Quarterly “red team” assessments of roadmap assumptions; rapid pivot mechanisms if technologies fail to mature
- **Geopolitical Hedging:** Diversified supply chains; strategic stockpiles of critical components
- **Implementation Diversity:** Avoid betting on single technologies; maintain parallel development tracks for critical capabilities

C Capability Profiles & Progression Matrices

Progression Matrix: [Insert Capability Name]

Metric &
Phase 1:
Foundation
& Compliance (0-5 Yrs)
& Phase 2:
Federation
& Standard-
ization (5-10
Yrs) & Phase
3: Autonomy
& Leadership

D Master Population Prompt for Roadmap Generation

Context: You are an expert EU Cybersecurity Policy Strategist. Your task is to populate the content for a Horizon Europe roadmap document based on the provided Master LaTeX structure.

Phase 1: Populate Section 4 (Architectural Summaries)

Using a `description` environment, provide a 2-3 sentence strategic summary for every Layer and Cross-Layer.

- **Layers 1–6:** Connect the technical component to its role in the continuum.
- **Cross-Layers 1–4:** Emphasize automation and governance.
- **Mandatory Hooks:** Reference **SNS JU SRIA** in 6.1, **Simpl Middleware** and **Common European Data Spaces** in CL3.1, and **EUCS/EUCC** in CL4.2.

Phase 2: Priority Selection & 7-Dimensional Analysis

Apply the **4-Filter Prioritization Framework** (Regulatory Urgency, Foundational Dependency, Sovereignty Cliff, and Market Feasibility) to justify the selection of the Top 3 Priorities:

1. **Priority 1:** Hardware Roots of Trust & EUCC 'High' Certification.
2. **Priority 2:** Post-Quantum Cryptographic (PQC) Agility for Edge/IoT.
3. **Priority 3:** Security Interoperability via Simpl Middleware.

For each priority, generate a full analysis using the **7-Dimensional Template** (Baseline/Target, Drivers, High Impact Activities, Catalysts/ECCC, Disruptors/Q-Day, Fail-safe, and Policy Meta-Layer).

Phase 3: Progression Matrices

Generate a LaTeX `tabular` matrix for each priority using the **ODP** (Operational Deployment Phase) and **SSL** (Strategic Sovereignty Level) metrics across the three time horizons.

- **Phase 1 (0-5 Yrs):** Target NIS2/CRA compliance and bridging foreign dependency.
- **Phase 2 (5-10 Yrs):** Focus on standardized federation and EU-wide certification.
- **Phase 3 (10-15 Yrs):** Achieve full sovereign autonomy and quantum-native resilience.

Tone & Style: Evaluator-grade, formal, and strictly aligned with the *European Industrial Technology Roadmap for the Next-Generation Cloud-Edge*.

E The Core Capability Dimensions (Architectural Framework)

The roadmap is structured across a cohesive architectural framework that spans four continuum environments (HPC, Cloud, Edge, Devices).

Part A: The Security Layers (Vertical Stack)

Layer 1.1 Hardware Roots of Trust: Cryptographically verifiable supply chain trust ensures physical device integrity from fabrication to deployment. Success depends on driving European open-hardware designs (e.g., RISC-V) toward **EUCC 'High' assurance** certification [5] to guarantee resistance against state-level physical tampering at the vulnerable far-edge.

Layer 2.1 OS & Middleware Hardening: Securing hypervisors and distributed operating systems across the continuum. This involves hardening KVM/QEMU and supporting sovereign, lightweight Linux distributions optimized for edge resource constraints, ensuring a minimal attack surface for cognitive workloads.

Layer 3.1 Workload Security: Securing containerized applications and serverless functions executing dynamically across multi-provider nodes. Implementation of hardened service meshes and sidecar proxy architectures provides mutual TLS and granular traffic inspection without impacting performance.

Layer 4.1 Zero-Trust Orchestration: Seamless policy enforcement across a multi-provider computing continuum requiring robust PEP/PDP architectures. This enables continuous authorization and dynamic access controls that adapt to the specific context of the request.

Layer 4.2 Federated Identity & Access Management (IAM): Cross-domain identity federation using Self-Sovereign Identity (SSI) principles. This allows for cryptographically secure, decentralized authentication for machines, users, and automated workloads across heterogeneous cloud-edge domains.

Layer 5.1 End-to-end Confidential Computing: Data-in-use security through Trusted Execution Environments (TEEs) spanning the entire Cloud-to-IoT data path. Leveraging TEE abstraction layers ensures that sensitive data remains encrypted even during processing in non-trusted environments.

Layer 5.2 Post-Quantum & Cryptographic Agility: PQC standardization and hybrid crypto deployment to secure long-lived data. Priority is placed on PQC migration for resource-constrained devices to neutralize “Harvest Now, Decrypt Later” quantum threats.

Layer 6.1 Telco-cloud & O-RAN Security: Hardening distributed 5G/6G cores and RAN components in strict alignment with the **Smart Networks and Services Joint Undertaking (SNS JU) SRIA** [7]. This ensures sovereign control over network slice isolation and virtualized RAN components.

Layer 6.2 Cross-Sector Physical Resilience & Safety: Adapting strict network controls and IT/OT gateway security for high-availability edge environments (e.g., Smart Grids). This prevents digital breaches from cascading into physical safety hazards or kinetic damage.

Part B: The Transversal Security Verticals (Cross-Layers)

CL1.1 Continuous DevSecOps (Shift-Left): Embedding AI-driven code analysis and automated vulnerability remediation at the earliest stages of the software lifecycle to ensure secure-by-design software delivery.

CL1.2 Model & Pipeline Integrity (DataBOMs): Securing AI training pipelines to prevent data poisoning and unauthorized model manipulation, ensuring the reliability of cognitive decisions at the edge.

CL1.3 Runtime AI Defense: Defending AI/ML infrastructure against real-world adversarial attacks, such as prompt injection and model evasion, specifically for models deployed in decentralized edge nodes.

CL2.1 Automated SOC Operations & Collaborative Threat Intelligence: Continuous monitoring and SOC federation across Member States. This utilizes legally protected, cross-border threat intelligence platforms to overcome institutional trust barriers [9].

CL2.2 Systemic & Cascading Risk Mitigation: Mapping the evolving threat landscape and using impact-likelihood scoring to dynamically sever links and prevent cross-domain systemic infrastructure failures.

CL3.1 Heterogeneous Interoperability & Simpl Integration: Secure communication across disparate systems via mandatory integration into the **Simpl** open-source smart middleware [6] to unlock **Common European Data Spaces**.

CL3.2 MIMs & Open Verifiability: Establishing Minimal Interoperability Mechanisms (MIMs) to ensure trust without vendor lock-in, relying on open-source hardware and software as fundamental prerequisites for transparency [6].

CL4.1 Policy-as-Code & Compliance-by-Design: Technical implementation of legal requirements (OSCAL) into machine-readable rules that pre-validate workloads before they are deployed to the continuum.

CL4.2 Continuous Automated Certification: Replacing point-in-time audits with real-time certification tracking for both cloud services (**EUCS**) and physical edge products (**EUCC**), ensuring compliance throughout the operational lifecycle [5].

CL4.3 Regulatory Digital Twins: Virtualized replicas of critical infrastructure used to stress-test regulatory compliance against evolving laws (e.g., Data Act, AI Act) without disrupting live operations.

F Capability Profiles & Progression Matrices

Priority 1: Hardware Roots of Trust & EUCC 'High' Certification

1. **Baseline & Target Objective:** *Baseline:* High foreign dependency on proprietary Trusted Platform Modules (TPMs) and secure elements. Far-edge devices lack standardized hardware anchors. *Target:* Ubiquitous deployment of EU-designed, open-source (RISC-V) secure enclaves certified at **EUCC 'High' assurance**, providing a mathematically verifiable foundation for the entire continuum.
2. **Primary Drivers:** *Threat:* State-level physical tampering and side-channel attacks on decentralized edge nodes. *Regulatory:* Mandatory hardware security requirements under the **Cyber Resilience Act (CRA)** and the need for certified anchors for **NIS2** critical infrastructure.
3. **High Impact Activities:** Development of sovereign European Secure Elements based on RISC-V; creation of automated hardware-level remote attestation protocols for large-scale edge fleets.
4. **Catalysts & Enablers:** **EU Chips Act** pilot lines for secure silicon; **EU Strategic Agenda** funding for open-hardware security; alignment with CEN/CENELEC hardware security standards.
5. **Disruptors & Systemic Risks:** Supply chain bottlenecks for EU-based fabrication; breakthroughs in physical side-channel analysis that bypass current cryptographic enclaves.
6. **Failsafe Mechanisms & Resilience:** Implementation of “defense-in-depth” where software-based isolation (TEEs) acts as a secondary layer if a specific hardware enclave is compromised; autonomous node isolation if attestation fails.
7. **Transversal Meta-Layer:** *Sovereignty:* Eliminates “black-box” hardware dependencies. *Sustainability:* Energy-efficient secure silicon designs reducing the carbon footprint of cryptographic operations at the far-edge.

Progression Matrix: Hardware Roots of Trust & EUCC 'High'

Metric &
Phase 1:
Foundation
& Compliance (0-5 Yrs)
& Phase 2:
Federation
& Standard-
ization (5-10
Yrs) & Phase
3: Autonomy
& Leadership

Priority 2: Post-Quantum Cryptographic Agility for Edge/IoT

1. **Baseline & Target Objective:** *Baseline:* Current IoT and edge infrastructure predominantly relies on classical cryptography (RSA, ECC) that is vulnerable to future quantum computers. There is limited awareness and no systematic migration path for resource-constrained devices. *Target:* A “Quantum-Native” continuum where all critical edge/IoT infrastructure has migrated to hybrid or full Post-Quantum Cryptography (PQC), with automated crypto-agility enabling seamless algorithm updates without hardware replacement.
2. **Primary Drivers:** *Threat:* The **Q-Day** threat—the point when Cryptographically Relevant Quantum Computers (CRQC) become operational. The “Harvest Now, Decrypt Later” strategy where adversaries capture encrypted data today to decrypt once quantum capabilities mature. *Regulatory:* Emerging ENISA guidelines and potential future EU mandates requiring PQC readiness for critical infrastructure under NIS2.
3. **High Impact Activities:** Optimization of NIST-standardized PQC algorithms (e.g., CRYSTALS-Kyber, CRYSTALS-Dilithium) for 8/16-bit microcontrollers; development of crypto-agility middleware enabling over-the-air algorithm updates; creation of automated cryptographic inventory and migration tools for legacy IoT deployments.
4. **Catalysts & Enablers:** **NIST PQC standardization finalization** (2024-2025); **ETSI** quantum-safe cryptography standards; **ENISA PQC guidelines**; **ECCC Strategic Agenda** funding for quantum-resilient infrastructure; integration with EU Chips Act for PQC-native silicon development.
5. **Disruptors & Systemic Risks:** Early arrival of CRQC before migration is complete (Q-Day cliff); performance overhead of PQC algorithms causing unacceptable power consumption on battery-powered IoT devices; fragmented standardization leading to incompatible implementations; insufficient cryptographic inventory of legacy OT/IoT systems preventing complete migration.
6. **Failsafe Mechanisms & Resilience:** Deployment of hybrid cryptographic schemes (classical + PQC) during the transition phase to maintain backward compatibility while providing quantum resistance; implementation of crypto-agility frameworks allowing rapid algorithm switching if vulnerabilities are discovered; diversification of PQC algorithm families to avoid single-point cryptanalytic failures.
7. **Transversal Meta-Layer:** *Sovereignty:* Protection of Europe’s long-term industrial and governmental secrets from future quantum decryption. *Sustainability:* Development of energy-efficient, lightweight PQC implementations reducing the carbon footprint of security (Green IT). *Trust:* Ensuring European citizens that their data remains confidential across decades, not just years.

Progression Matrix: Post-Quantum Cryptographic Agility for Edge/IoT

Metric &
Phase 1:
Foundation
& Compliance (0-5 Yrs)
& Phase 2:
Federation
& Standard-
ization (5-10
Yrs) & Phase
3: Autonomy
& Leadership

Priority 3: Security Interoperability via Simpl Middleware

1. **Baseline & Target Objective:** *Baseline:* Current European cloud and edge infrastructure is highly fragmented across proprietary vendor silos, each with incompatible security policies, authentication mechanisms, and data exchange protocols. This fragmentation prevents seamless data flow across Common European Data Spaces and creates vendor lock-in. *Target:* A unified European “Trust Fabric” enabling secure, federated interoperability across heterogeneous cloud and edge providers through mandatory integration with the **Simpl** open-source smart middleware stack, with standardized security Minimal Interoperability Mechanisms (MIMs).
2. **Primary Drivers:** *Regulatory:* **Data Act** mandates requiring seamless data portability and interoperability; requirements for Common European Data Spaces (Health, Manufacturing, Agri-Food, etc.) to operate across multiple providers; NIS2 requirements for coordinated incident response across federated infrastructure. *Market:* Breaking vendor lock-in to enable European SMEs to compete; enabling cross-border data flows while maintaining sovereignty.
3. **High Impact Activities:** Implementation and standardization of security-specific **Minimal Interoperability Mechanisms (MIMs)** within the Simpl stack; development of automated policy translation engines converting provider-specific security policies into a common, machine-readable format (e.g., XACML, OSCAL); creation of federated identity bridges connecting disparate IAM systems using verifiable credentials; deployment of cross-domain security orchestration enabling unified threat response.
4. **Catalysts & Enablers:** **Digital Europe Programme** funding for Simpl development and pilot deployments; **Simpl open-source stack** community and governance; alignment with **Gaia-X** federation services and trust frameworks; ECCC support for security MIM standardization; CEN/CENELEC standardization of interoperability protocols.
5. **Disruptors & Systemic Risks:** Vendor resistance to open standards threatening adoption; weakest-link security failures in federated systems where one provider’s compromise cascades across the entire fabric; complexity of policy translation creating semantic gaps or enforcement inconsistencies; fragmented national implementations creating “data islands” rather than true European interoperability.
6. **Failsafe Mechanisms & Resilience:** Capability to autonomously “unfederate” or isolate nodes that fail to meet the shared security baseline, preventing compromise propagation; implementation of zero-trust architectures where federation does not imply implicit trust; continuous compliance monitoring with automated ejection of non-compliant providers; cryptographic attestation of policy enforcement ensuring verifiable security guarantees.
7. **Transversal Meta-Layer:** *Sovereignty:* Breaking dependence on non-EU hyper-scaler lock-in by enabling European providers to compete on equal footing. *Trust:*

Fostering pan-European cross-border trust through transparent, verifiable security mechanisms. *Economic Viability:* Enabling SMEs to participate in Data Spaces without massive security infrastructure investments through standardized, reusable security components.

Progression Matrix: Security Interoperability via Simpl Middleware

Metric &
Phase 1:
Foundation
& Compliance (0-5 Yrs)
& Phase 2:
Federation
& Standard-
ization (5-10
Yrs) & Phase
3: Autonomy
& Leadership

G Executive Summary & Strategic Recommendations

Executive Summary

This cybersecurity and cyber-resilience strategy defines a comprehensive 15-year trajectory to secure the European Cloud-Edge-IoT Continuum against emerging threats while establishing digital sovereignty. The strategy moves beyond traditional perimeter defenses toward autonomous, federated, and certified Security-by-Design architectures.

By utilizing a **4-Filter Prioritization Framework** (Regulatory Urgency, Foundational Dependency, Sovereignty Cliff, and Market Feasibility), we identify three critical path priorities for Phase 1 (2025-2030): **Hardware Roots of Trust & EUCC 'High' Certification**, **Post-Quantum Cryptographic Agility for Edge/IoT**, and **Security Interoperability via Simpl Middleware**. These priorities ensure that foundational infrastructure is hardened against both physical and quantum threats while enabling secure, sovereign cross-border data flows.

The roadmap employs a dual-metric progression framework: **Operational Deployment Phase (ODP)** tracking market integration, and **Strategic Sovereignty Level (SSL)** measuring European independence from foreign technology dependencies. This enables objective tracking of capability maturity across three distinct phases: Foundation & Compliance (0-5 years), Federation & Standardization (5-10 years), and Autonomy & Leadership (10-15 years).

Strategic Recommendations for Phase 1 (2025–2030)

To operationalize this strategy, the following actions are recommended for immediate European R&I funding and policy alignment:

- **Accelerate Sovereign Secure Silicon Development:** Immediate Horizon Europe and EU Chips Act funding for open-source RISC-V secure elements and hardware roots of trust engineered to meet **EUCC 'High' assurance levels**. Establish pilot fabrication lines dedicated to security-critical components to reduce 100% foreign dependency on TPMs and secure enclaves.
- **Operationalize Crypto-Agility for the Edge/IoT:** Develop and standardize automated crypto-agility middleware frameworks that allow resource-constrained IoT devices to upgrade to **Post-Quantum Cryptography (PQC)** without requiring hardware replacement. Prioritize ENISA guidelines alignment and ECCC funding for lightweight PQC implementations targeting 8/16-bit microcontrollers.
- **Enforce Security-by-Design via Simpl Integration:** Mandate standardized security **Minimal Interoperability Mechanisms (MIMs)** across all Common European Data Spaces to ensure security policies are provider-agnostic, cryptographically verifiable, and eliminate vendor lock-in. Align Digital Europe Programme funding with Simpl stack security module development.

- **Harmonize Continuous Certification Lifecycles:** Transition from static, point-in-time PDF certificates to **Continuous Automated Assurance** frameworks using telemetry-driven compliance verification. Develop real-time certification tracking standards for both cloud services (**EUCS**) and physical edge products (**EUCC**), ensuring autonomous compliance maintenance throughout operational lifecycles.
- **Establish Federated Cyber Resilience Capabilities:** Invest in cross-border SOC federation infrastructure and legally protected threat intelligence sharing platforms to overcome institutional trust barriers between Member States. Align with CONCORDIA project outcomes and ECCC Strategic Agenda priorities for collaborative defense.
- **Synchronize Regulatory Enforcement Timelines:** Ensure coordinated enforcement of NIS2, Cyber Resilience Act (CRA), and AI Act requirements by 2026-2027 to create unified market incentives for security investment. Provide targeted support for SMEs to meet compliance requirements without creating insurmountable barriers to market entry.

Success Metrics for 2030

By the end of Phase 1, Europe should achieve:

- **Hardware Sovereignty:** At least 30% of critical infrastructure edge nodes utilizing EU-designed, EUCC 'High' certified secure elements.
- **Quantum Readiness:** 100% of new critical IoT deployments supporting hybrid PQC schemes; complete cryptographic inventory of legacy systems.
- **Federated Trust:** Majority of Common European Data Spaces operating on Simpl-based security interoperability with standardized MIMs.
- **Certification Maturity:** Operational continuous certification frameworks for at least two major Data Spaces with real-time EUCS/EUCC tracking.

H Summary outcome

I Section X: Cybersecurity & Cyber-Resilience Strategy for Sovereign Cloud/Edge Computing

Topic: Cybersecurity for the Cognitive Computing Continuum

Destinations:

- **Primary:** 4. A secure, sovereign European computing continuum infrastructure.
- **Secondary:** 6. European leadership in emerging disruptive computing paradigms.

I.1 1. Background & Driving Factors

- **Decentralization Risk:** The paradigm shift from the centralized Cloud to a distributed Cloud-Edge-IoT continuum radically expands the attack surface. This creates environments that are often “too many, too diverse, and too dispersed” to secure with traditional perimeter defenses.
- **Physical Exposure:** Edge nodes frequently operate in the field. Unlike hyper-scaler data centers, they lack strict physical security, making them highly vulnerable to tampering and side-channel attacks.
- **Regulatory Pressure:** There is an immediate need to operationalize the NIS2 Directive, the Cyber Resilience Act (CRA), and the AI Act across a fragmented landscape.
- **Digital Sovereignty:** Europe must reduce systemic reliance on non-EU providers to mitigate extra-territorial data access risks and geopolitical vendor lock-in.

I.2 2. Europe in Relation to the State of the Art

- **EU Strengths:** Europe leads in Trust, Privacy-by-Design, and standardized certification frameworks like EUCS and EUCC.
- **EU Gaps:** Fragmentation in threat intelligence and a critical dependency on non-EU secure silicon (hardware).
- **Strategic Goal:** Transition from “reactive, siloed security” to “autonomous, federated, and certified Security-by-Design.”

I.3 3. Strategic Preamble

The strategy is organized into a two-part framework:

1. **Capability Profiles (Qualitative):** 7-dimensional analysis defining what must be built.
2. **Progression Matrix (Quantitative):** Tracking evolution via Operational Deployment Phases (ODP) and Strategic Sovereignty Levels (SSL).

I.4 4. The Core Capability Dimensions (Architectural Framework)

I.4.1 Part A: The Security Layers (Vertical Stack)

Layer 1.1 Hardware Roots of Trust: Supply chain trust ensuring physical integrity. Focus on driving European open-hardware (RISC-V) toward EUCC 'High' certification.

Layer 2.1 OS & Middleware Hardening: Securing hypervisors and distributed OS. Focus on sovereign, lightweight Linux distributions optimized for edge constraints.

Layer 3.1 Workload Security: Securing containerized apps via hardened service meshes and mutual TLS to provide granular inspection without performance loss.

Layer 4.1 Zero-Trust Orchestration: PEP/PDP architectures enabling continuous authorization and dynamic access controls across multi-provider domains.

Layer 4.2 Federated Identity (IAM): Utilizing Self-Sovereign Identity (SSI) for cryptographically secure, decentralized authentication for machines and users.

Layer 5.1 Confidential Computing: Data-in-use security through TEEs (Trusted Execution Environments) spanning the entire Cloud-to-IoT data path.

Layer 5.2 Post-Quantum Cryptography (PQC): Migration to quantum-resistant algorithms for resource-constrained devices to neutralize “Harvest Now, Decrypt Later” threats.

Layer 6.1 Telco-cloud & O-RAN: Hardening 5G/6G cores in alignment with the SNS JU SRIA to ensure sovereign control over network slice isolation.

Layer 6.2 Physical Resilience & Safety: IT/OT gateway security for critical infra (Smart Grids) to prevent digital breaches from causing kinetic damage.

I.4.2 Part B: The Transversal Verticals (Cross-Layers)

CL1.1 Continuous DevSecOps: AI-driven code analysis and automated remediation at the earliest stages of the software lifecycle.

CL1.2 Model Integrity (DataBOMs): Securing AI pipelines to prevent data poisoning and unauthorized model manipulation at the edge.

CL2.1 Automated SOC & Threat Intel: SOC federation across Member States using legally protected platforms to overcome institutional trust barriers.

CL3.1 Interoperability & Simpl Integration: Mandatory integration into the Simpl middleware to unlock Common European Data Spaces.

CL4.2 Automated Certification: Real-time certification tracking for cloud services (EUCS) and edge products (EUCC) throughout their lifecycle.

I.5 5. The 4-Filter Prioritization Framework

To identify the “Critical Path” for Phase 1 (0-5 Yrs), we apply:

- **Regulatory Urgency:** Required by 2026 (CRA/NIS2).
- **Foundational Dependency:** Technical requirement for lower layers to anchor higher ones.
- **Sovereignty Cliff:** Addressing 100% foreign dependency or immediate threats like Q-Day.
- **Market Feasibility:** Alignment with existing EU investments like Simpl.

Executive Priorities (Phase 1):

1. Priority 1: Hardware Roots of Trust & EUCC 'High' Certification.
2. Priority 2: Post-Quantum Cryptographic (PQC) Agility for Edge/IoT.
3. Priority 3: Security Interoperability via Simpl Middleware.

I.6 6. Detailed Priority Profiles & Progression Matrices

I.6.1 Priority 1: Hardware Roots of Trust & EUCC 'High'

Baseline/Target: Move from foreign TPM dependency to sovereign RISC-V enclaves with EUCC 'High' certification.

Drivers: Physical tampering at edge; CRA mandates. **Catalysts:** EU Chips Act.

Failsafe: Distributed attestation.

Metric & Phase 1 (0-5 Yrs) & Phase 2 (5-10 Yrs) & Phase 3 (10-15 Yrs)
ODP & Frag- mented Piloting & Standardized Integration & Ubiquitous Op- eration SSL & High Foreign Dep. & Emerging EU Ecosystem & Full Sovereign Autonomy State & RISC- V pilots begin. & EU elements in critical in- fra. & Sovereign trust by default. Enabler & CRA Enforce- ment & EUCC 'High' Cert & EU Chips Act production

I.6.2 Priority 2: PQC Agility for Edge/IoT

Baseline/Target: Transition to "Quantum-Native" continuum.

Drivers: Q-Day threat. **Failsafe:** Hybrid (Classical + PQC) signatures.

Metric & Phase 1 (0-5 Yrs) & Phase 2 (5-10 Yrs) & Phase 3 (10-15 Yrs)
ODP & Ap- plied R&D & Fragmented Piloting & Ubiquitous Op- eration SSL & High Foreign Dep. & Emerging EU Ecosystem & Full Sovereign Autonomy State & Al- gorithm se- lection. & Hybrid schemes in IIoT. & Full quantum- resilience. Enabler & ENISA PQC Guidelines & NIST/ETSI Finalization & PQC-native RISC-V silicon

I.6.3 Priority 3: Security Interoperability via Simpl Middleware

Baseline/Target: Proprietary silos to unified European “Trust Fabric.”

Drivers: Data Act mandates. **Catalysts:** Digital Europe Programme; Simpl stack.

I.7 References

[NIS2] Directive (EU) 2022/2555 on measures for high common cybersecurity.

[CRA] Cyber Resilience Act, COM (2022) 454 final.

[EUCC] ENISA candidate cybersecurity certification scheme (Common Criteria).

[Cloud-Edge] European industrial technology roadmap for next-gen cloud-edge (2024).

[SNS JU] Strategic Research and Innovation Agenda for 6G.

Metric & Phase 1 (0-5 Yrs) & Phase 2 (5-10 Yrs) & Phase 3 (10-15 Yrs)
ODP & Fragmented Piloting & Standardized Integration & Ubiquitous Operation
SSL & Emerging EU Ecosystem & Full Sovereign Auton. & Full Sovereign Auton.
State & Initial Simpl pilots. & Policy translation via MIMs. & Provider-agnostic fabric.
Enabler & Simpl-Open Launch & Security MIMs adoption & EU Cloud Rulebook

References

- [1] European Parliament and Council, “Directive (EU) 2022/2555 on measures for a high common level of cybersecurity across the Union (NIS2 Directive),” *Official Journal of the European Union*, Dec. 2022.
- [2] European Commission, “Proposal for a Regulation on horizontal cybersecurity requirements for products with digital elements and amending Regulation (EU) 2019/1020 (Cyber Resilience Act),” COM(2022) 454 final, Sep. 2022.
- [3] European Parliament and Council, “Regulation (EU) 2024/1689 laying down harmonised rules on artificial intelligence (Artificial Intelligence Act),” *Official Journal of the European Union*, Jun. 2024.
- [4] European Union Agency for Cybersecurity (ENISA), “European Cybersecurity Certification Scheme for Cloud Services (EUCS),” Candidate Scheme, Dec. 2020.
- [5] European Union Agency for Cybersecurity (ENISA), “EUCC, a candidate cybersecurity certification scheme to serve as a successor to the existing SOG-IS,” V1.0, Jul. 2020.

- [6] European Alliance for Industrial Data, Edge and Cloud, “European industrial technology roadmap for the next-generation cloud-edge,” European Commission, 2024.
- [7] Smart Networks and Services Joint Undertaking (SNS JU), “Strategic Research and Innovation Agenda (SRIA),” 2023.
- [8] European Cybersecurity Competence Centre (ECCC), “ECCC Strategic Agenda for cybersecurity industrial, technology and research competence,” 2024.
- [9] G. Dreo, C. Schmitt, A. van der Wees, and N. Suri, “Deliverable D4.4: Cybersecurity Roadmap for Europe,” *CONCORDIA Cyber Security Competence for Research and Innovation (Horizon 2020)*, Dec. 2022.